Denny's Star Adventure

Tracing lines, shapes, numbers and mazes · Ages 3–5

This book belongs to:

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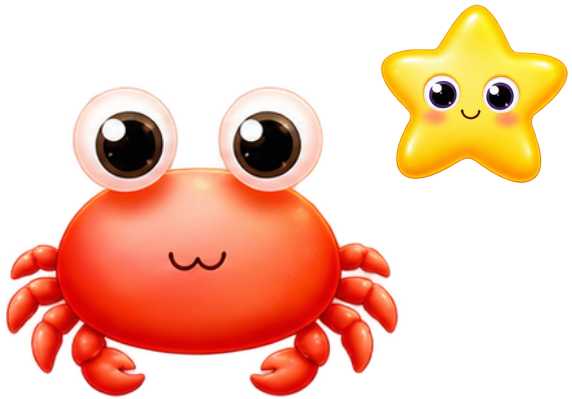
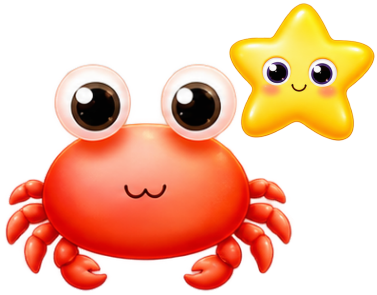


Welcome to Denny's Star Adventure!



Ages three to five are full of big firsts: first lines, first shapes, first "why?" questions. This book turns those first pencil strokes into an adventure. Your child will help Denny the little crab carry a fallen star named Twinkle all the way home to the sky, tracing, counting and solving mazes along the way.

Every page also shares one small, true fact about the ocean, the forest or space, so each activity becomes a chance to talk, wonder and learn together.

With this book, your child will:

- strengthen little hands with lines, curves and loops
- practice pencil control for early writing
- recognize and draw basic shapes
- trace and count numbers from 1 to 10
- solve mazes, from easy to tricky
- learn to stay focused until the end
- discover fun facts about the sea, the forest and space

Symbols in this book

7 Main task

Bonus task

Start here

Finish here

How to use this book

- Read the little story out loud first. It gives every line a reason!
- Two or three pages a day is plenty. Stop while it's still fun.
- The pages get harder as Denny travels, so it's best to go in order.
- Wobbly lines are perfectly fine. Just erase and try again.
- Praise the effort, not only the result.

What you'll need

A soft pencil with an eraser. A triangular pencil is easiest for small hands. Colored pencils are great for the coloring tasks. Markers and felt pens may show through to the other side of the page.

Doing an activity together

1. Read the main task and look at the picture together. Ask a question, like "Where did Twinkle go?"
2. Trace the path with a finger first, then with the pencil.
3. Start at the arrow, stay inside the path and stop at the star.
4. Then try the bonus task. Give hints, but let your child find the answer.
5. Celebrate every finished page!

When the adventure is over

Look back at the first pages together and see how much steadier the lines have become. Then fill in the Star Explorer Certificate at the back of the book!

Learning through play

Denny's adventures are built on one simple idea: children learn best when they're curious and having fun. The story gives every line a purpose, and the fun facts spark new questions. Along the way, Denny and his friends show kindness, teamwork and what it means to help someone in need.

Moving step by step from easy pages to harder ones builds real confidence. You may even discover new talents in your little one along the way!

Choosing a pencil

For little hands just starting out, a chunky triangular pencil works best. Its shape gently guides the fingers into a comfortable grip.

Pick a soft lead, like HB or 2B, so lines are easy to see and easy to erase. As your child grows more confident, a regular pencil works just as well.

Holding the pencil

The pencil rests on the middle finger, while the thumb and pointer finger pinch it gently near the tip.

The ring finger and little finger curl softly into the palm.

A relaxed grip is best. Squeezing too hard makes little hands tired quickly.

If your child holds the pencil a different way, don't worry. Show the grip again from time to time and it will come with practice.

A relaxed, comfortable grip

Three things to remember

- **Follow your child's interest.**
- **Talk about every page.**
- **Praise, praise, praise!**

Have a tablet?

More Denny here

Meet Denny and his friends!

Hi! I'm Denny, a little crab who lives at the bottom of the sea with Mommy Coral, Daddy Reef and my little sister Sandy. My best friends are Ollie the octopus, Shelly the turtle and Pearl the jellyfish. Soon I'll meet new friends in the forest, too. Will you come on an adventure with me?

Denny
a brave little crab

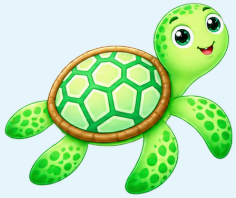
Mommy Coral
Denny's mom

Daddy Reef
Denny's dad

Sandy
Denny's little sister

Twinkle
a little fallen star

Ollie
the clever octopus



Shelly
the kind sea turtle

Pearl
the glowing jellyfish

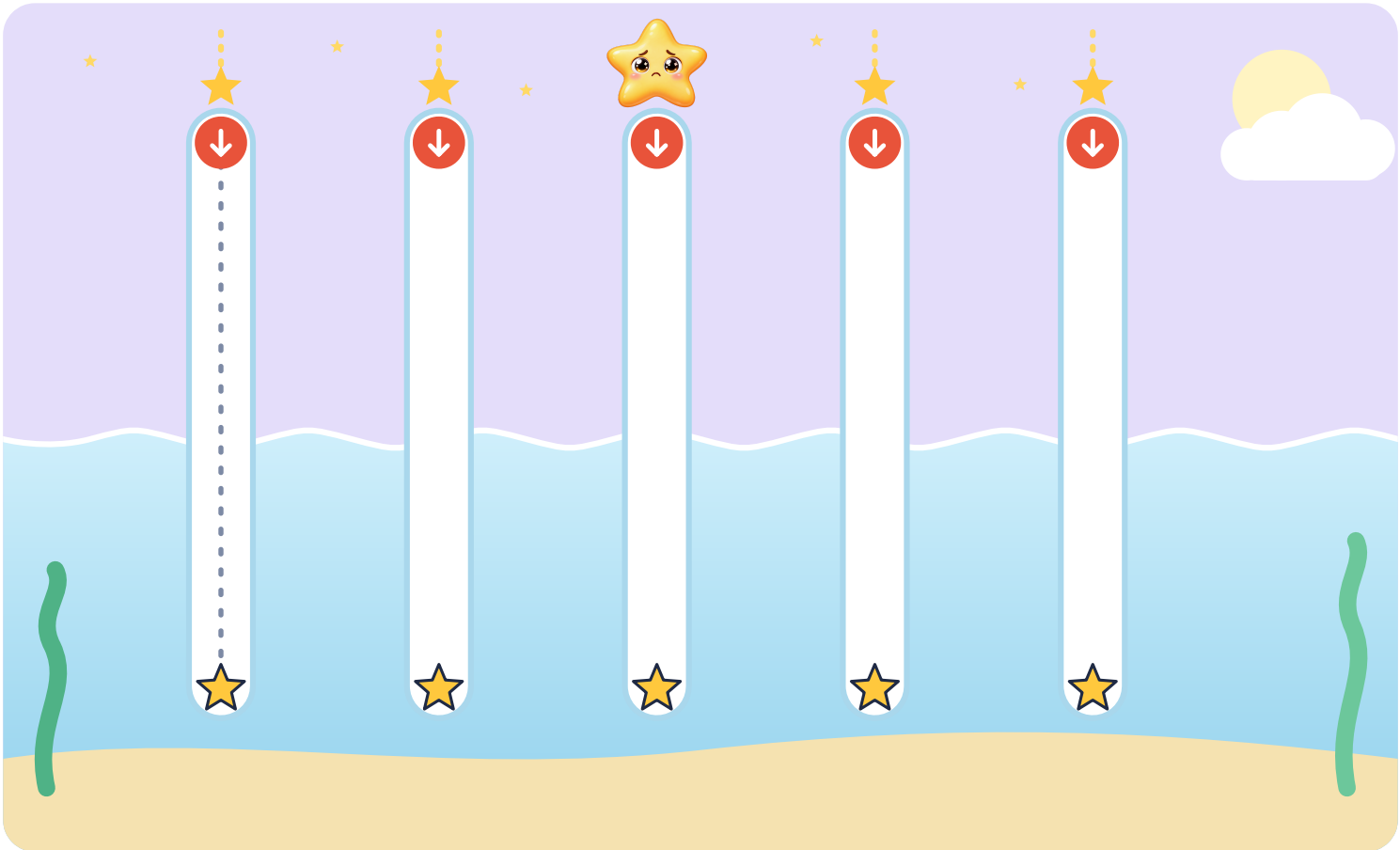
Finn
the friendly fox

Glow
the little firefly

1 Oh no, the little star is falling from the sky! She drops straight down, down, down into the sea. Trace the straight lines from the top to the bottom to show how she fell.

Can you find the moon hiding behind a cloud?

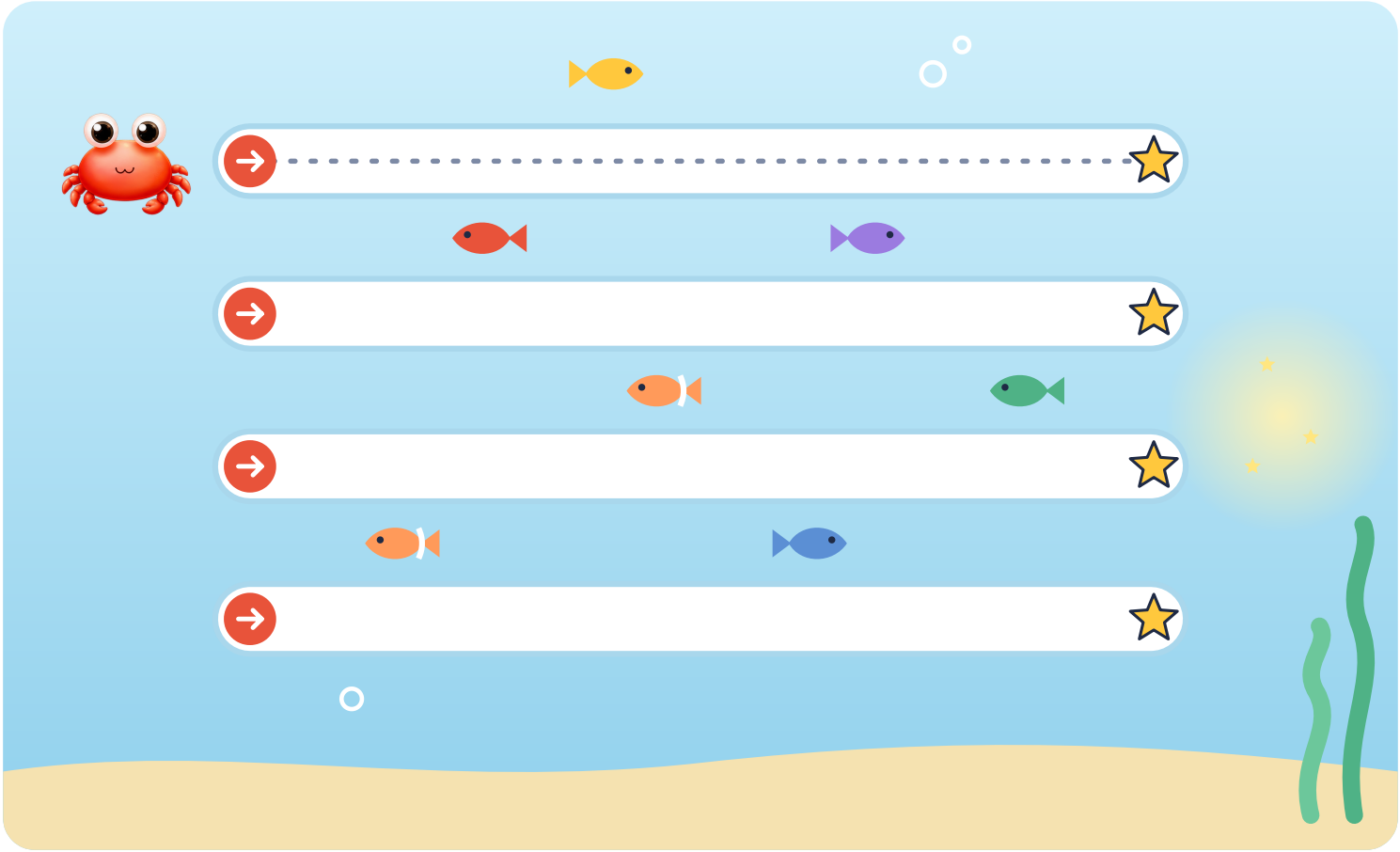
Date



2 Splash! Denny saw something land far away. Crabs walk sideways, so Denny scuttles side to side across the sand. Trace the straight lines across the page to help him hurry over.

Find two fish that look exactly the same.

Date



3 The little star is drifting slowly through the water, swaying this way and that. Where did she go? Draw the curvy line to follow her all the way down and find her.

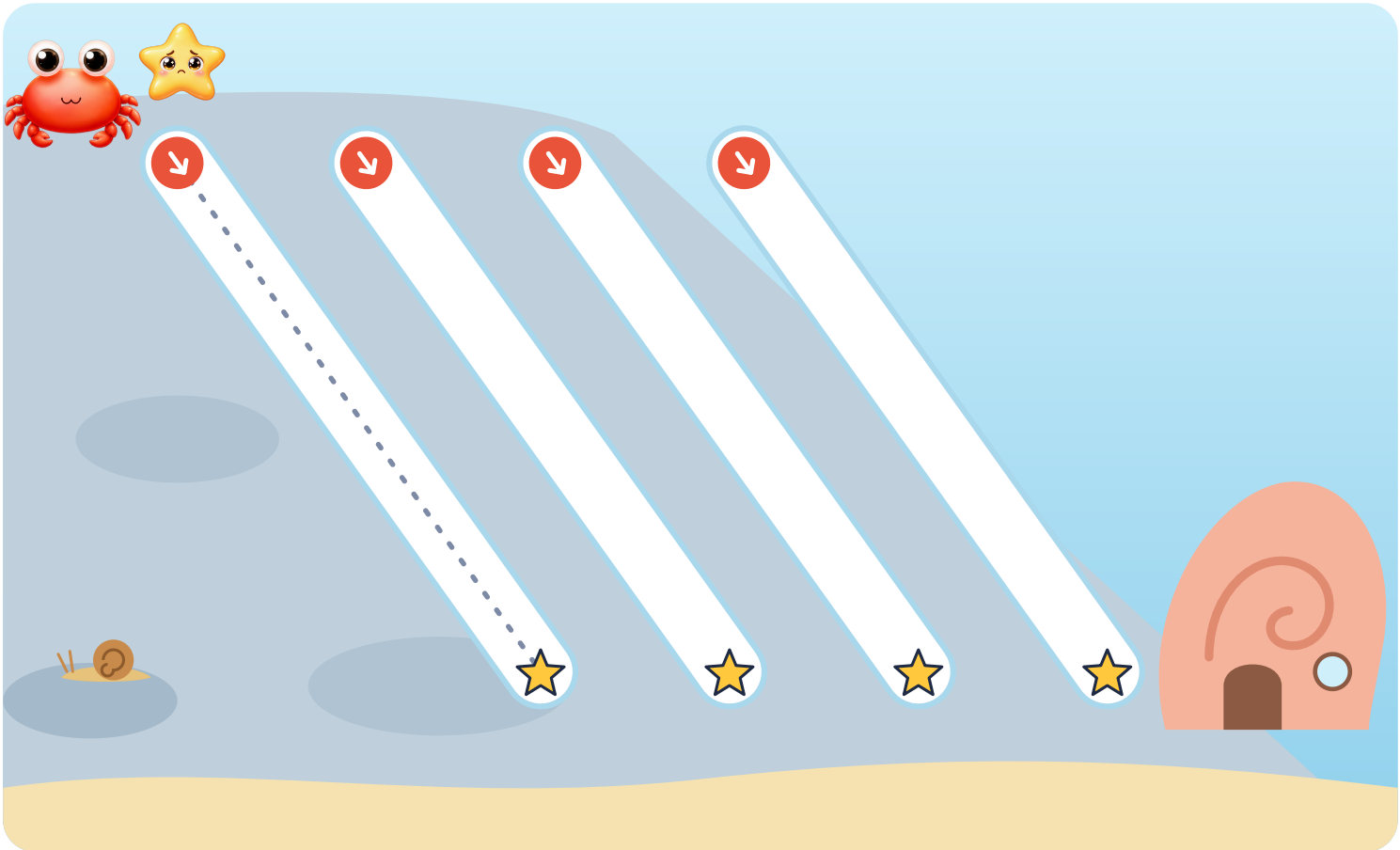
Count the bubbles floating up. How many are there?

Date

4 Denny found her! Her name is Twinkle, and she is sad because her light is fading. "I miss the sky," she whispers. Denny promises to take her home. Trace the slanted lines to help Denny carry Twinkle down the rocks to his house.

Find the little snail hiding on a rock.

Date



5 Denny shows Twinkle to Mommy Coral, Daddy Reef and little sister Sandy. "You're very brave," says Mommy Coral. "The sky is far away, so you'll need help from your friends." Waves are made by the wind blowing over the sea. Trace the wavy lines to send a message to Denny's friends.

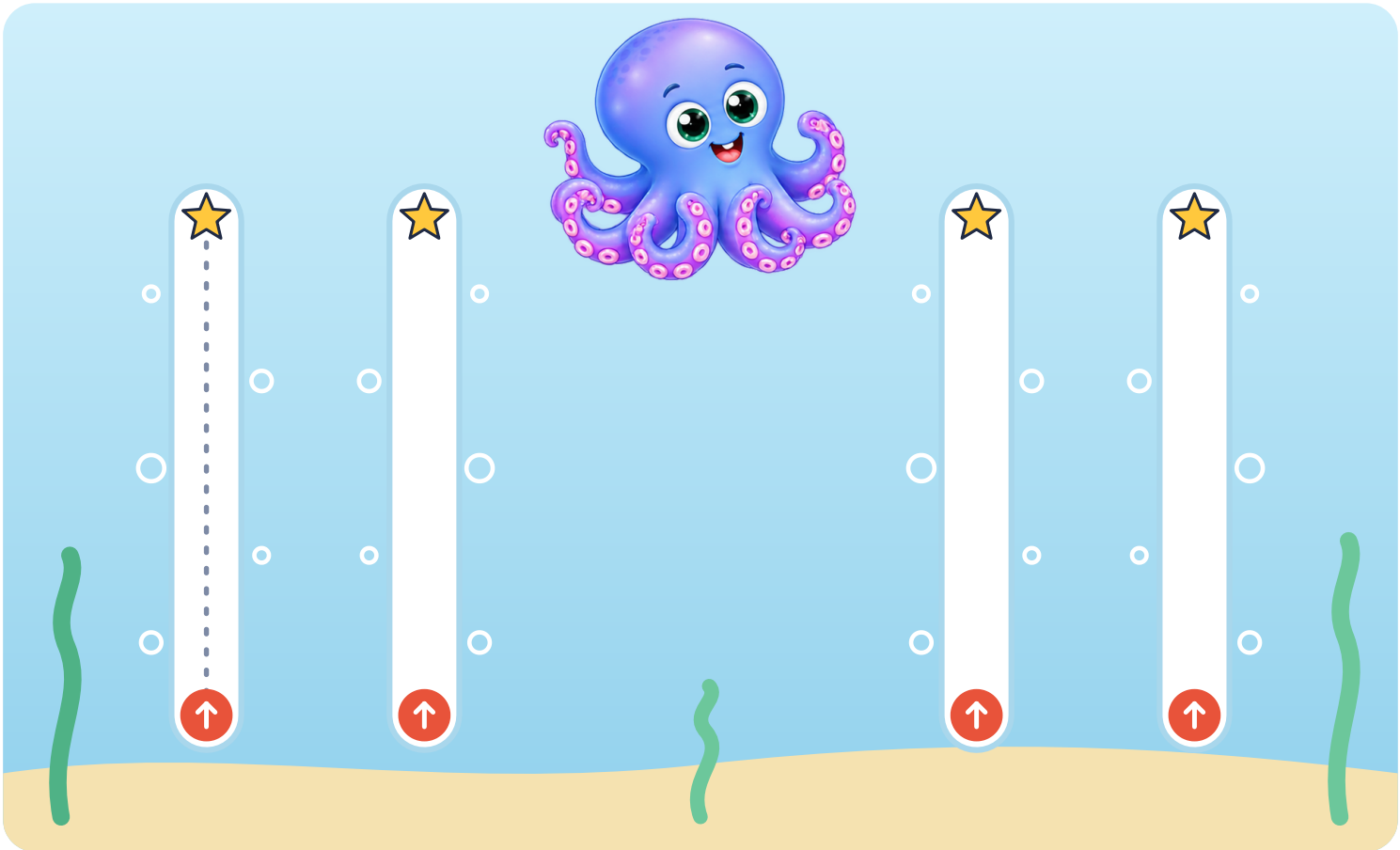
Sandy is holding something red. Circle it.

Date

6 Ollie the octopus is the first friend to arrive! Ollie has 8 long arms and can change color to hide. Trace the lines from the bottom to the top to follow the bubbles up to Ollie.

Count Ollie's arms. Are there really 8?

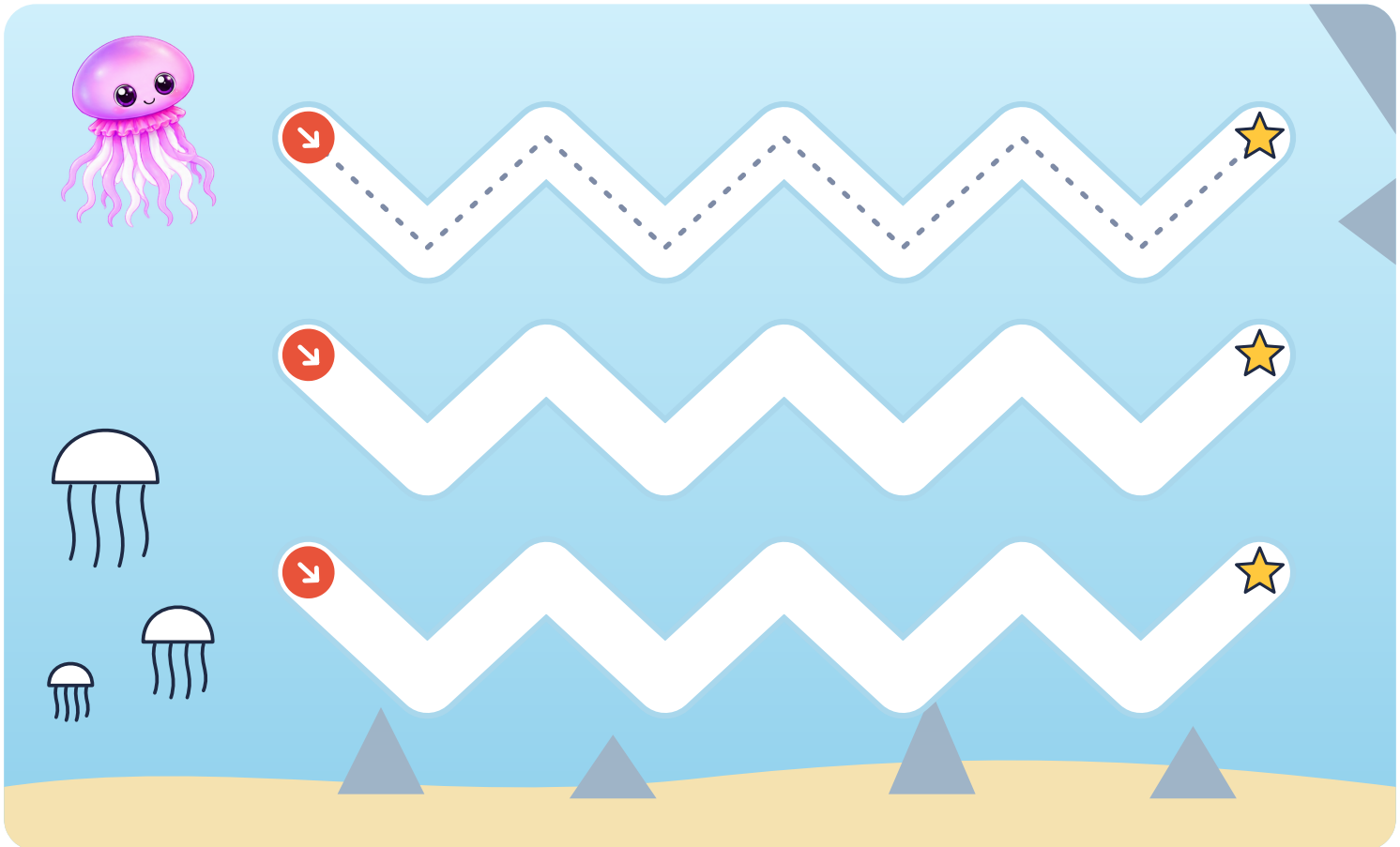
Date



7 Pearl the jellyfish wants to help too! Jellyfish have no bones and no brain, but they can glow in the dark. Trace the zigzag lines to help Pearl drift between the rocks.

Color the smallest jellyfish.

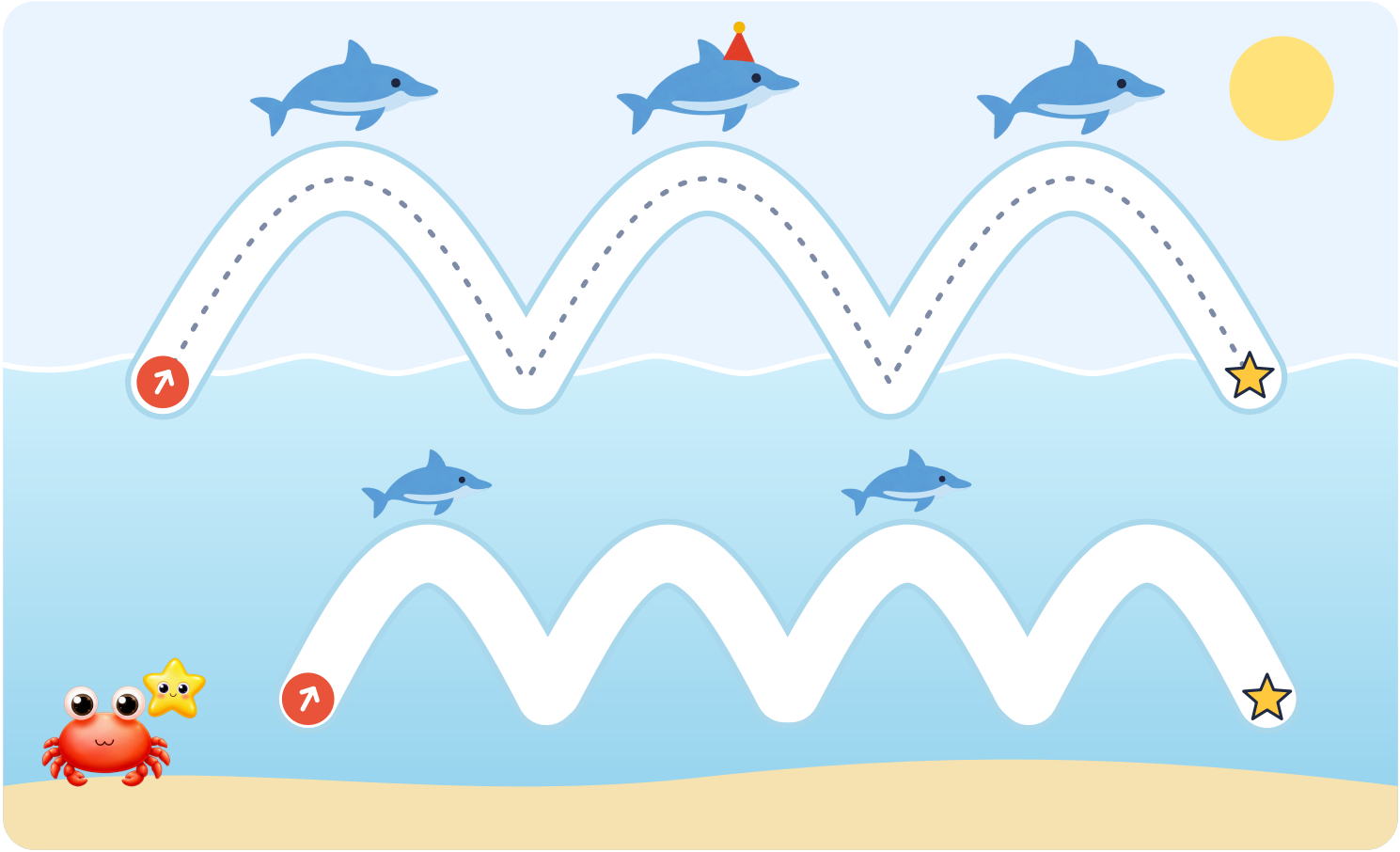
Date



8 Dolphins leap out of the water and dive back in, up and down. They are saying hello to Twinkle! Dolphins breathe air, just like you. Trace the bumpy lines to follow each dolphin's jump.

One dolphin is wearing a tiny hat. Can you find it?

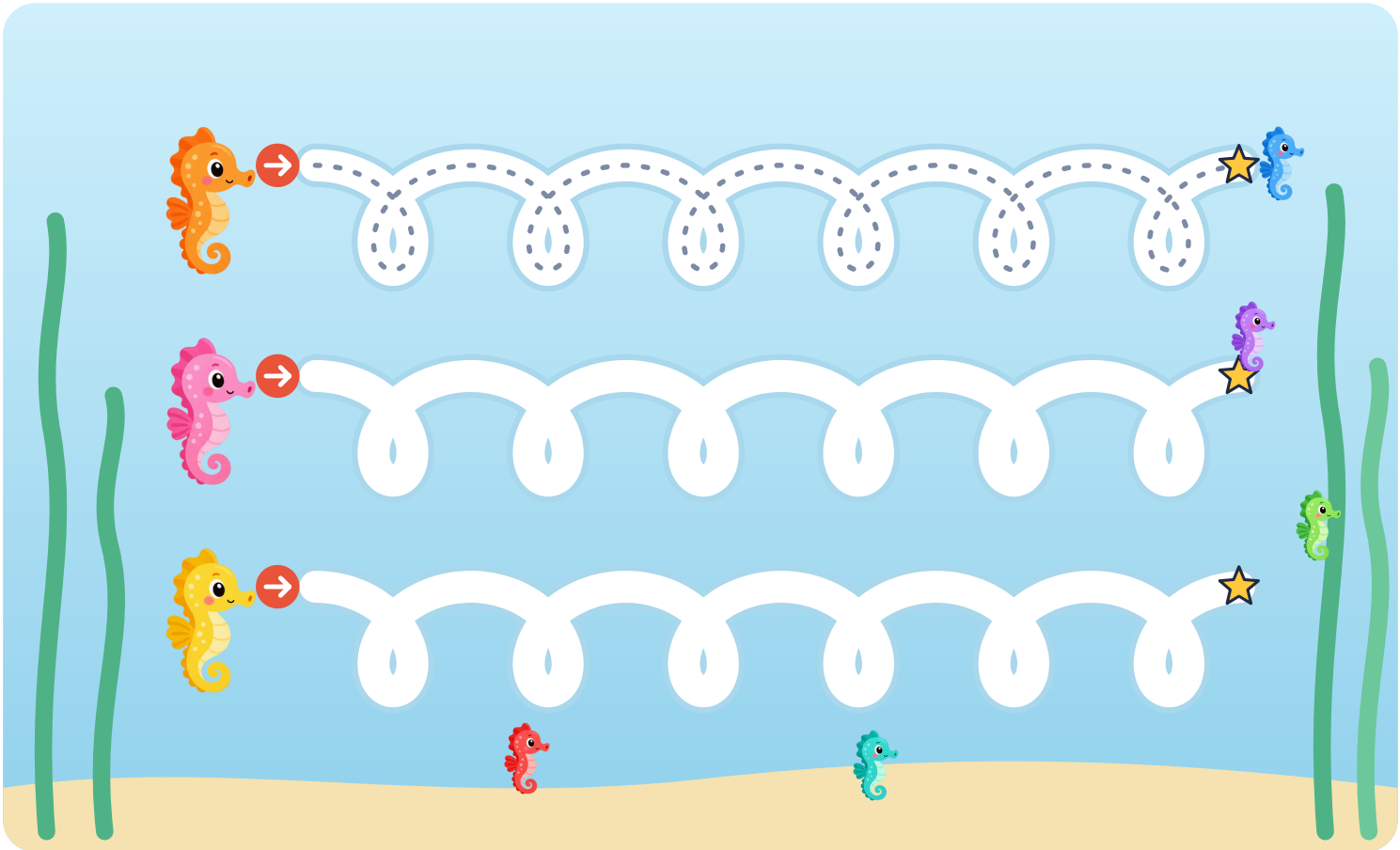
Date



9 The seahorses curl their tails into little loops to hold on to the seaweed. Did you know that seahorse dads carry the babies before they hatch? Trace the loopy lines to help the seahorses swim.

How many baby seahorses can you count?

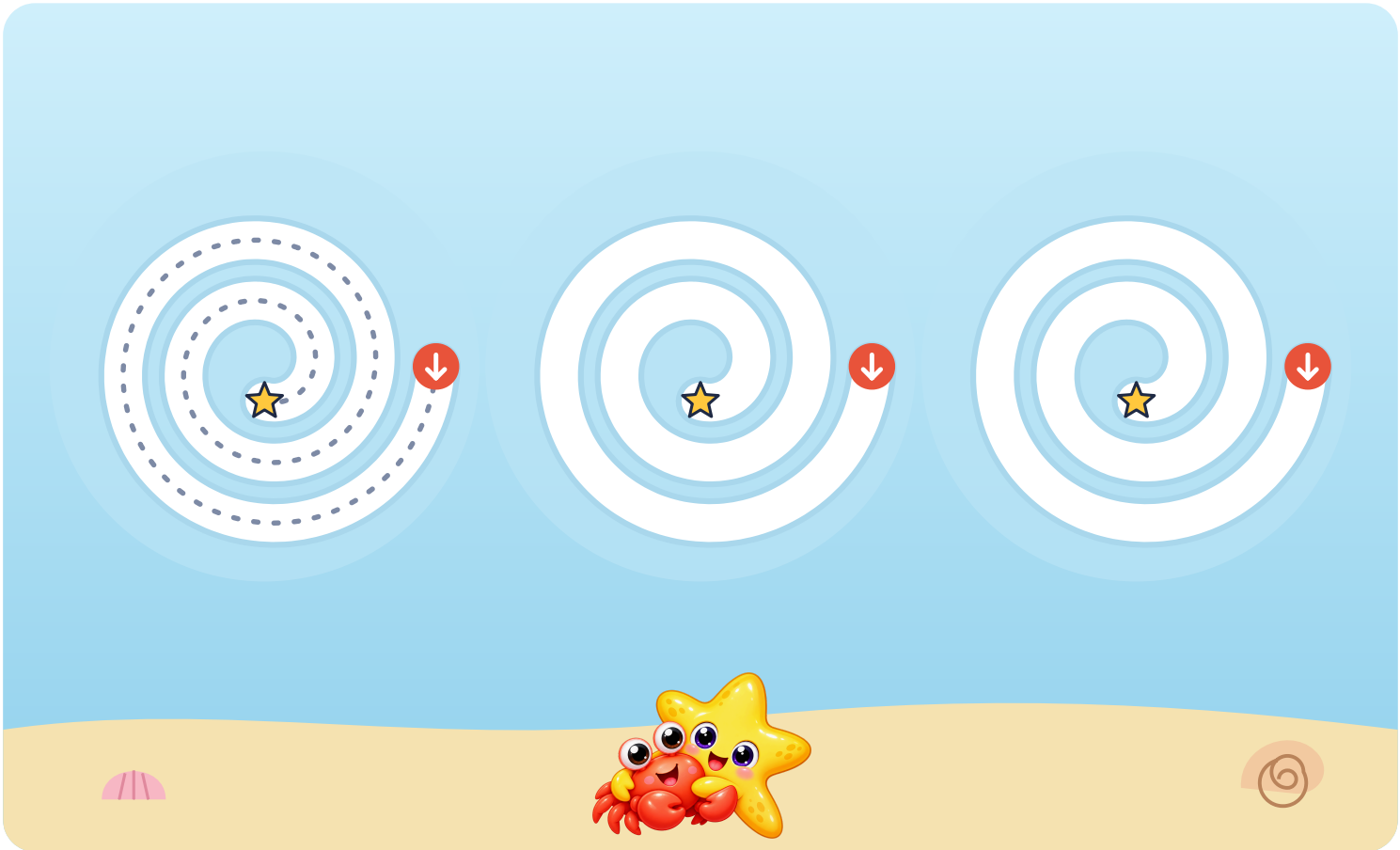
Date



10 Whoosh! A swirly whirlpool is spinning in the sand. Denny holds Twinkle tight. Trace the spirals from the outside in to see how the water spins.

Find the shell shaped like a spiral.

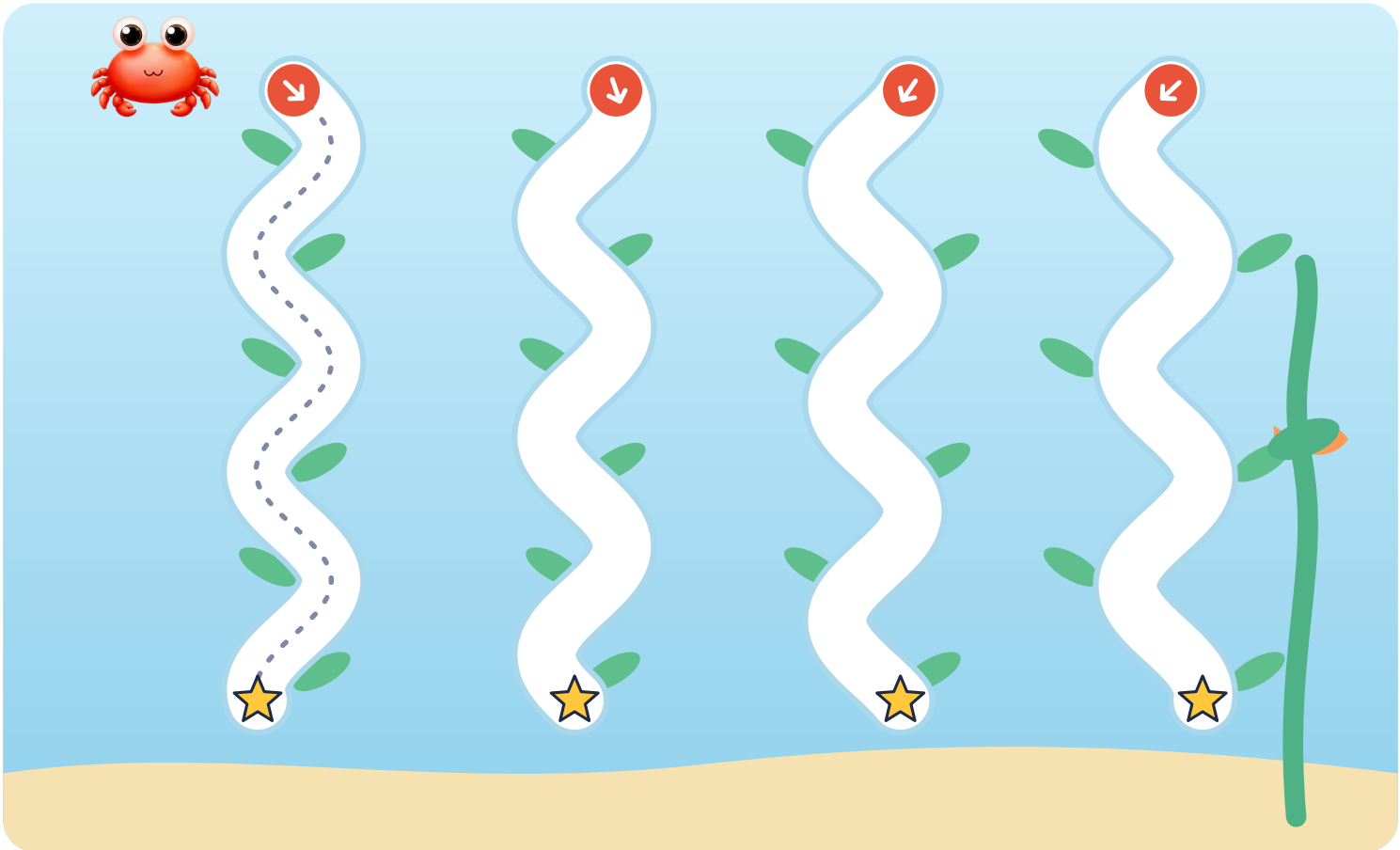
Date



11 The kelp forest is full of tall, wavy seaweed. Kelp can grow taller than a house! Trace the wavy lines from top to bottom to help Denny climb down through the kelp.

A fish is hiding in the kelp. Circle it.

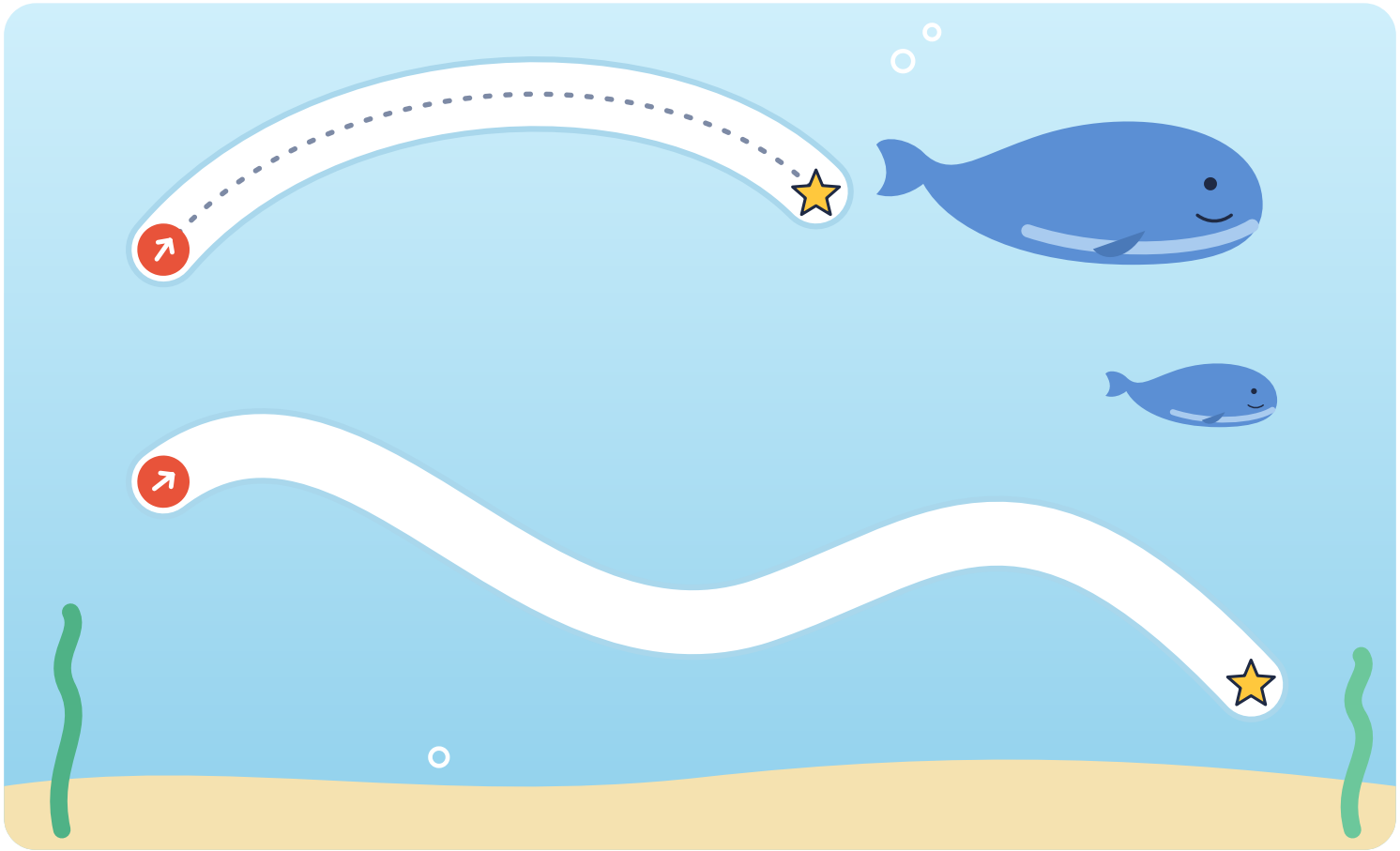
Date



12 A gentle whale swims by and sings a deep, humming song. Whales are the biggest animals in the whole world. Trace the big curves to follow the whale's path through the ocean.

Find the baby whale swimming close to its mom.

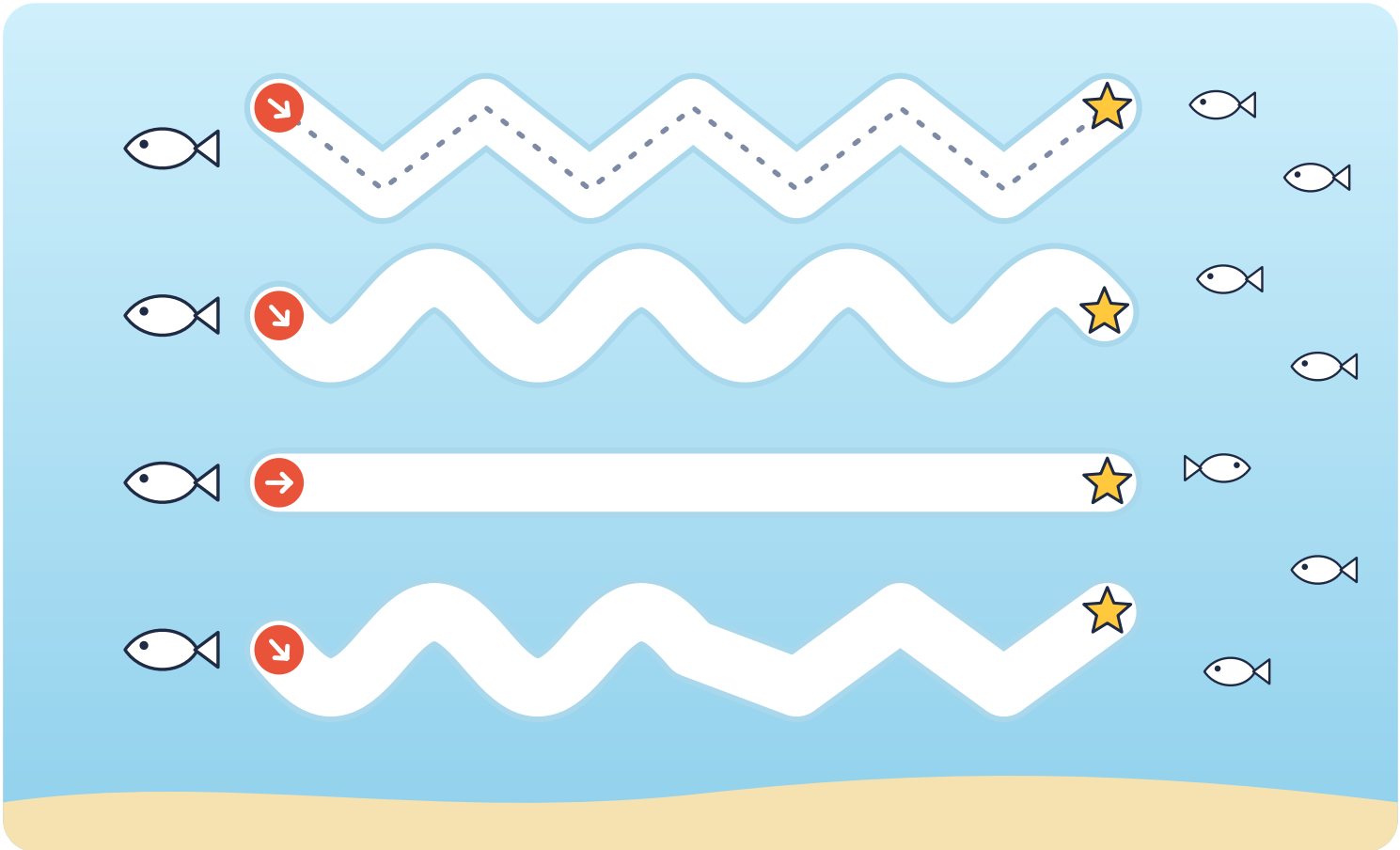
Date



13 A school of fish zooms past, some swimming in zigzags and some in waves. Fish breathe underwater using gills. Trace each line to see which way the fish are going.

Which fish is swimming the other way? Color it.

Date



14 Shelly the turtle swims up with a smile. "Hop on my shell, Denny! I'll take you and Twinkle to the shore." Sea turtles have to swim up to the surface to breathe. Trace the long line to help Shelly carry her friends up, up, up to the beach.

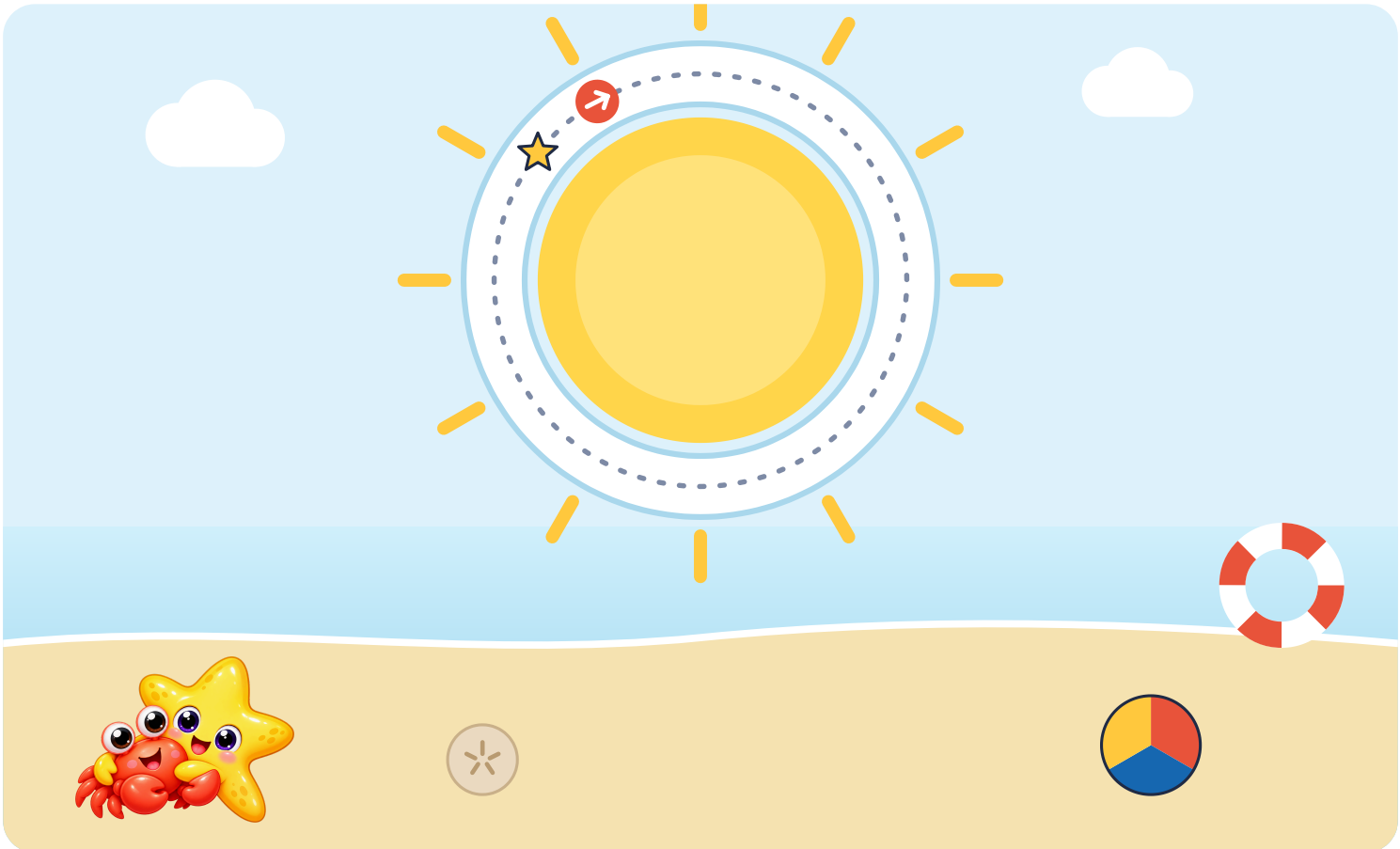
Say goodbye to Ollie and Pearl. Can you find them waving?

Date

15 Denny climbs onto the warm sand and squints at the bright sun. "The sun is a star too, just like me!" says Twinkle. It is the closest star to Earth. Trace the big round circle to finish the sun.

Find three more circles on the beach.

Date

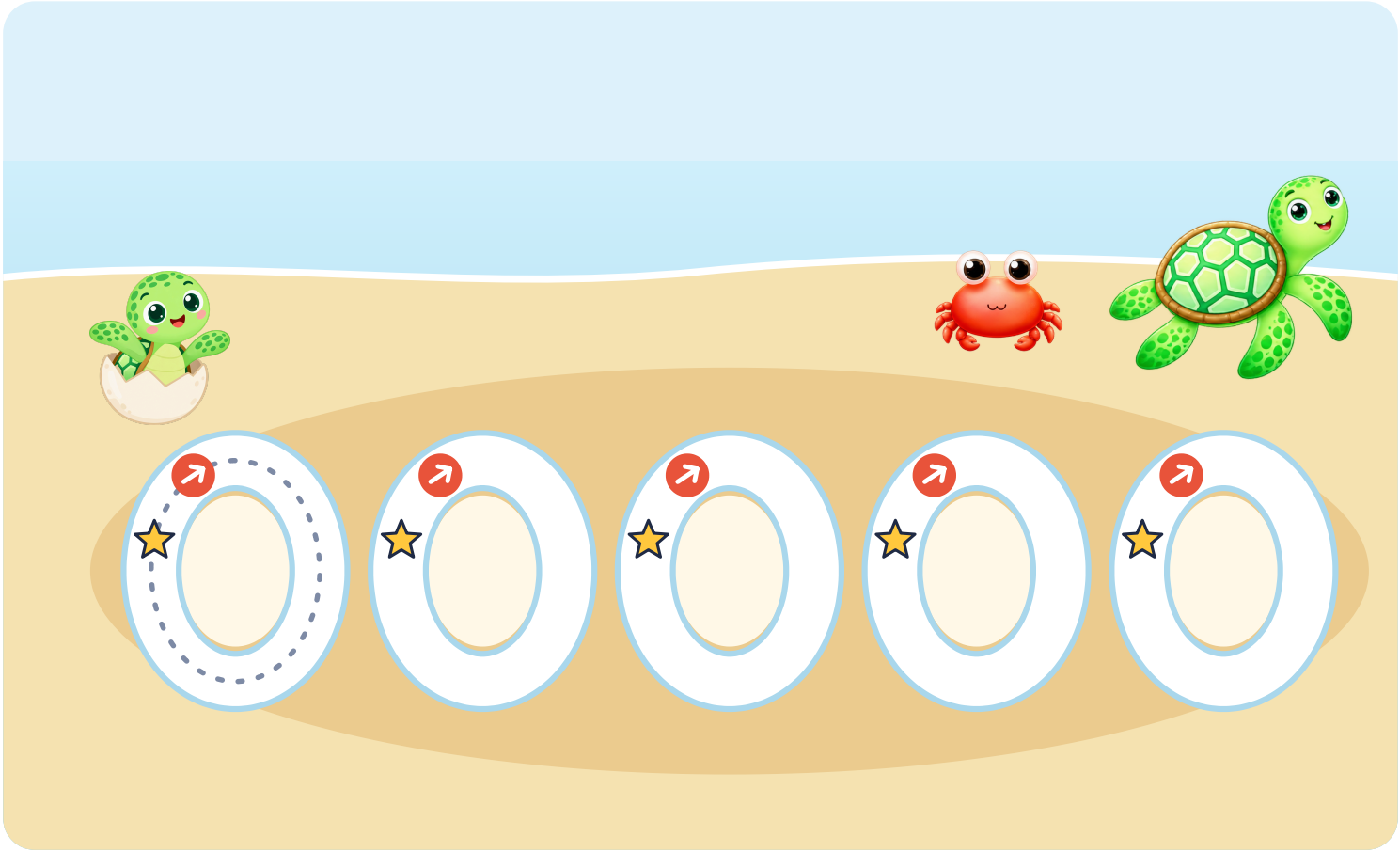


16

Shelly shows Denny a special spot in the sand. "This is where sea turtles lay their eggs!" Baby turtles hatch and crawl to the sea all by themselves. Trace the ovals to finish the turtle eggs.

One baby turtle is already hatching. Circle it.

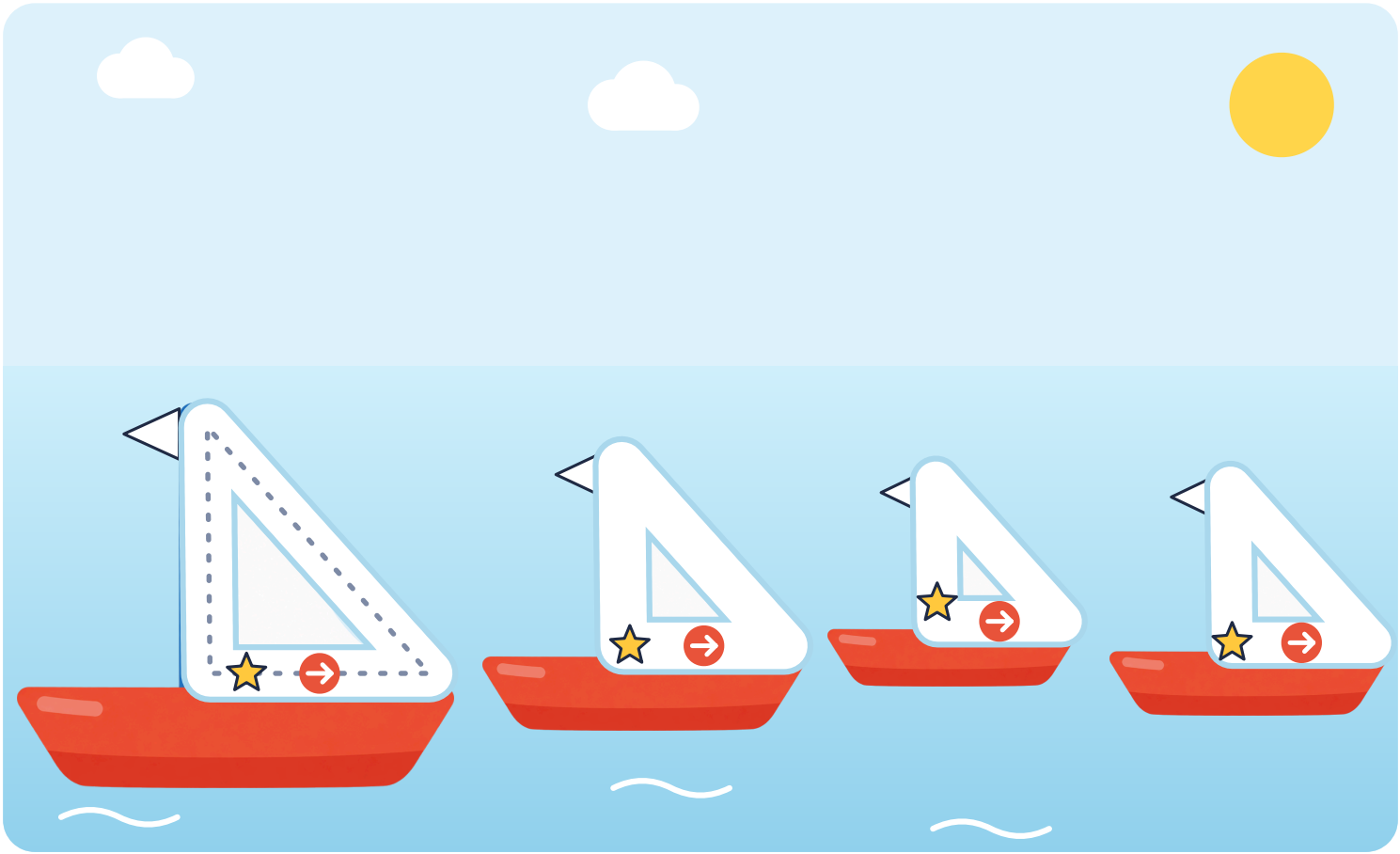
Date



17 Sailboats are gliding across the water. The wind pushes on their sails to make them move. Trace the triangles to give every boat a sail.

Which boat is the biggest? Color its flag.

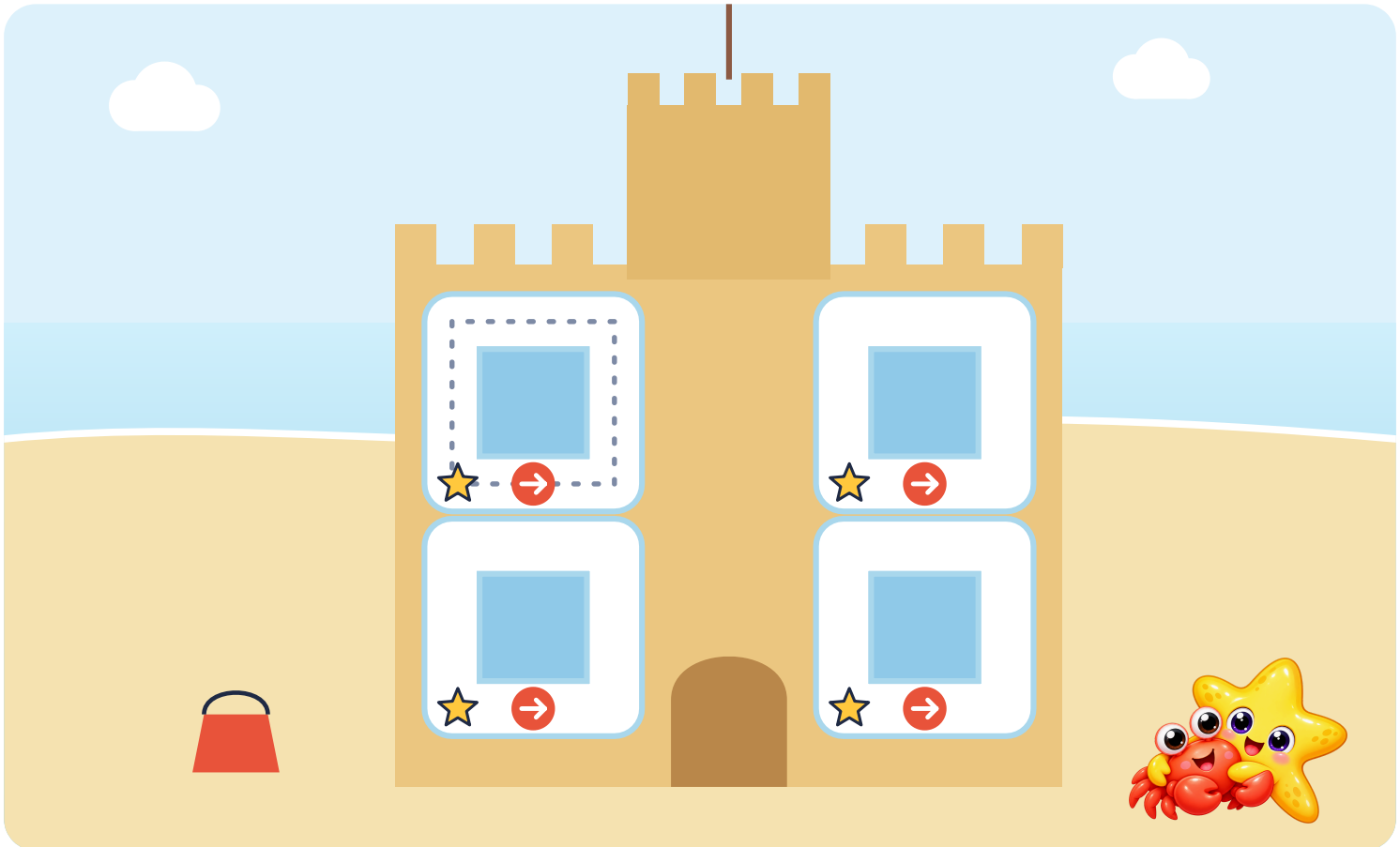
Date



18 Some children built a tall sandcastle! Denny and Twinkle peek inside. Trace the squares to finish the castle's windows.

Draw a little flag on top of the tower.

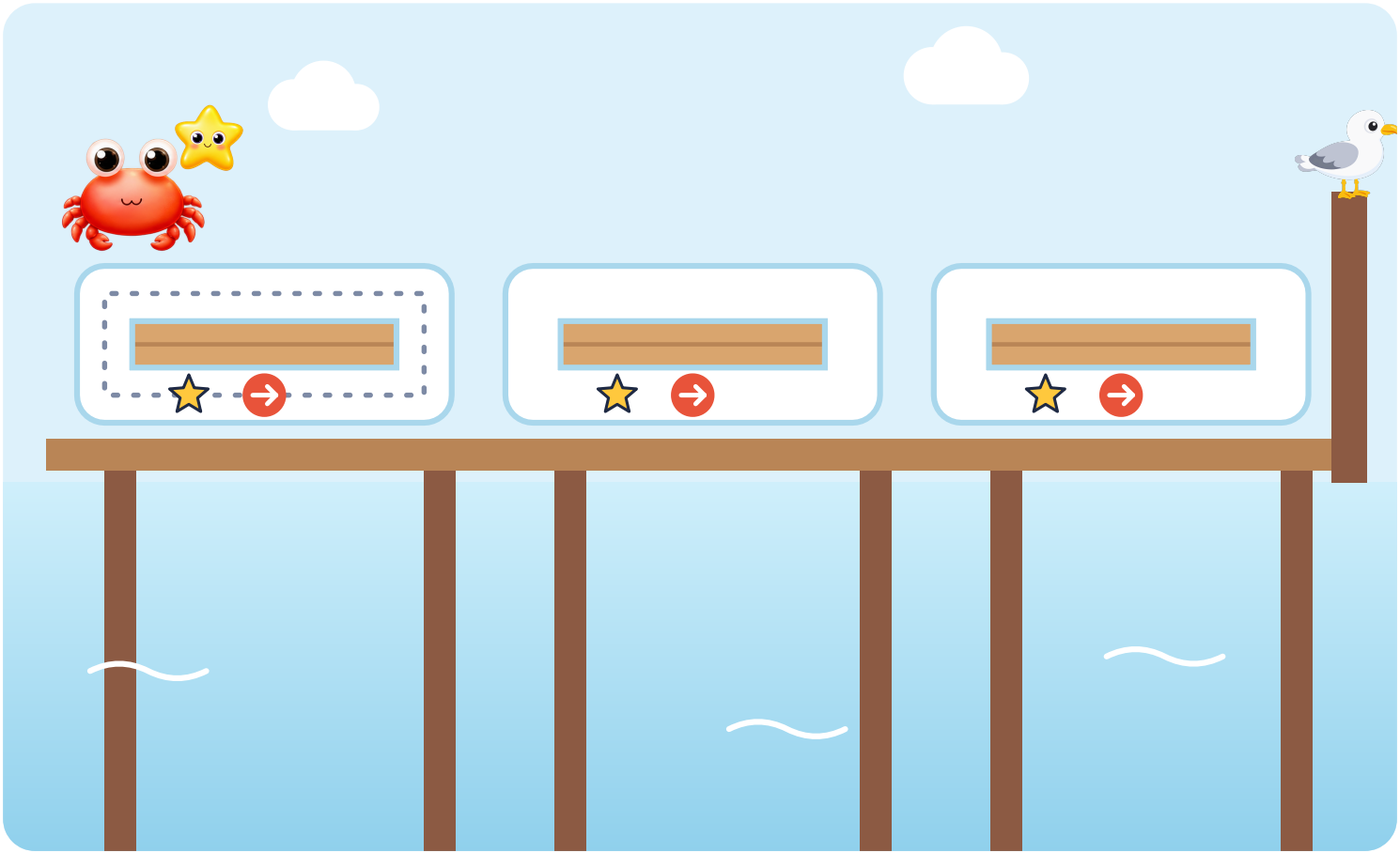
Date



19 Denny walks along a wooden pier to see the ocean from up high. The pier stands on tall posts so the waves can pass underneath. Trace the long rectangles to finish the planks and help Denny walk across.

A seagull is sitting on one of the posts. Can you find it?

Date



20 Shelly has to go back to the sea now. Before she goes, Denny gives her a shell shaped like a heart. "Thank you for the ride, Shelly!" Trace the hearts to show how much Denny loves his friend.

Count the hearts on the page.

Date

21 Look! The sea stars on the rocks have 5 arms, just like Twinkle has 5 points. "Maybe we're cousins!" giggles Twinkle. Trace the stars to finish the sea stars.

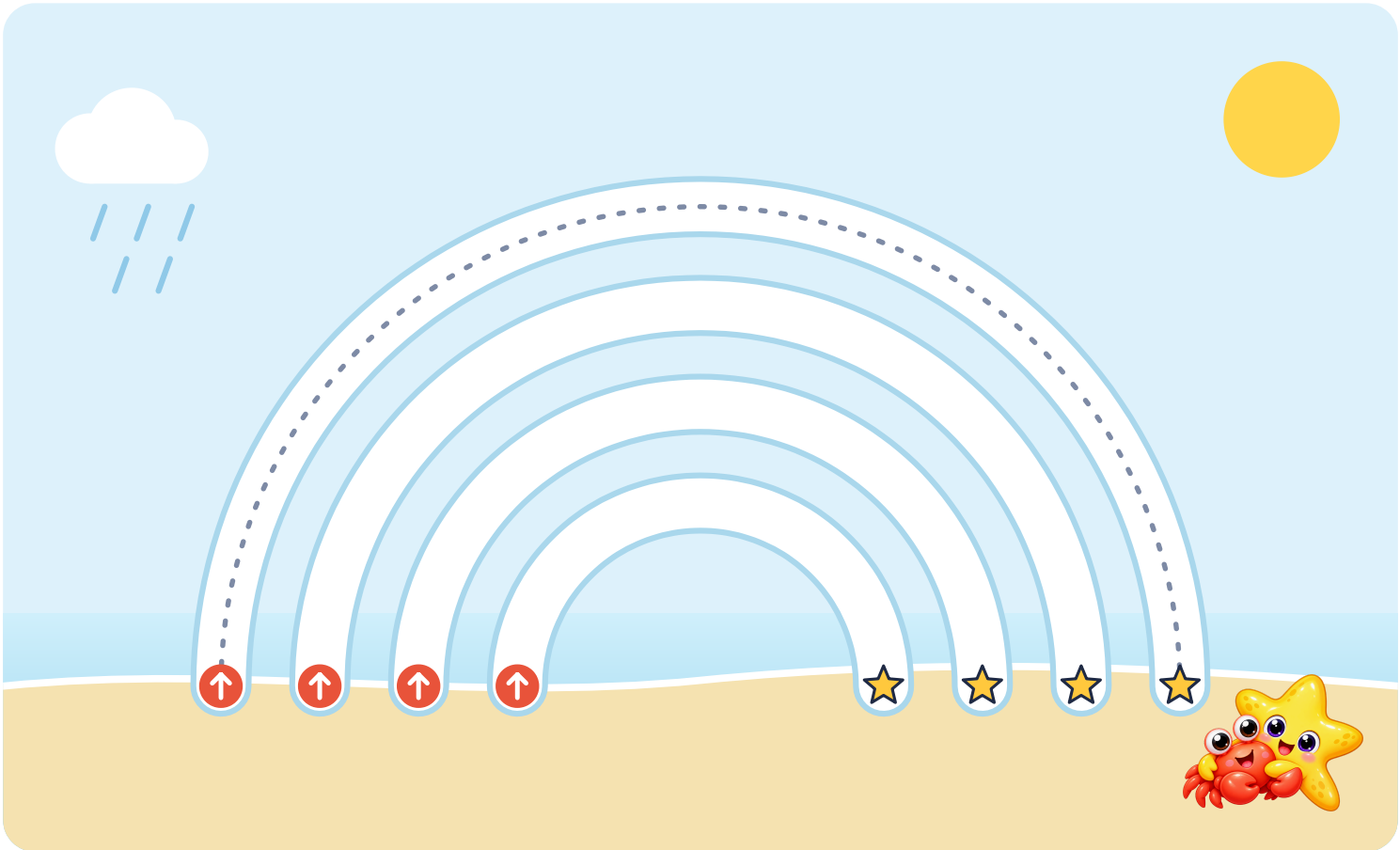
One sea star has only 4 arms. Find it!

Date

22 It starts to rain a little, and then the sun comes out again. A rainbow! Rainbows appear when sunlight shines through raindrops. Trace the half circles to paint the rainbow.

Color the rainbow using your favorite colors.

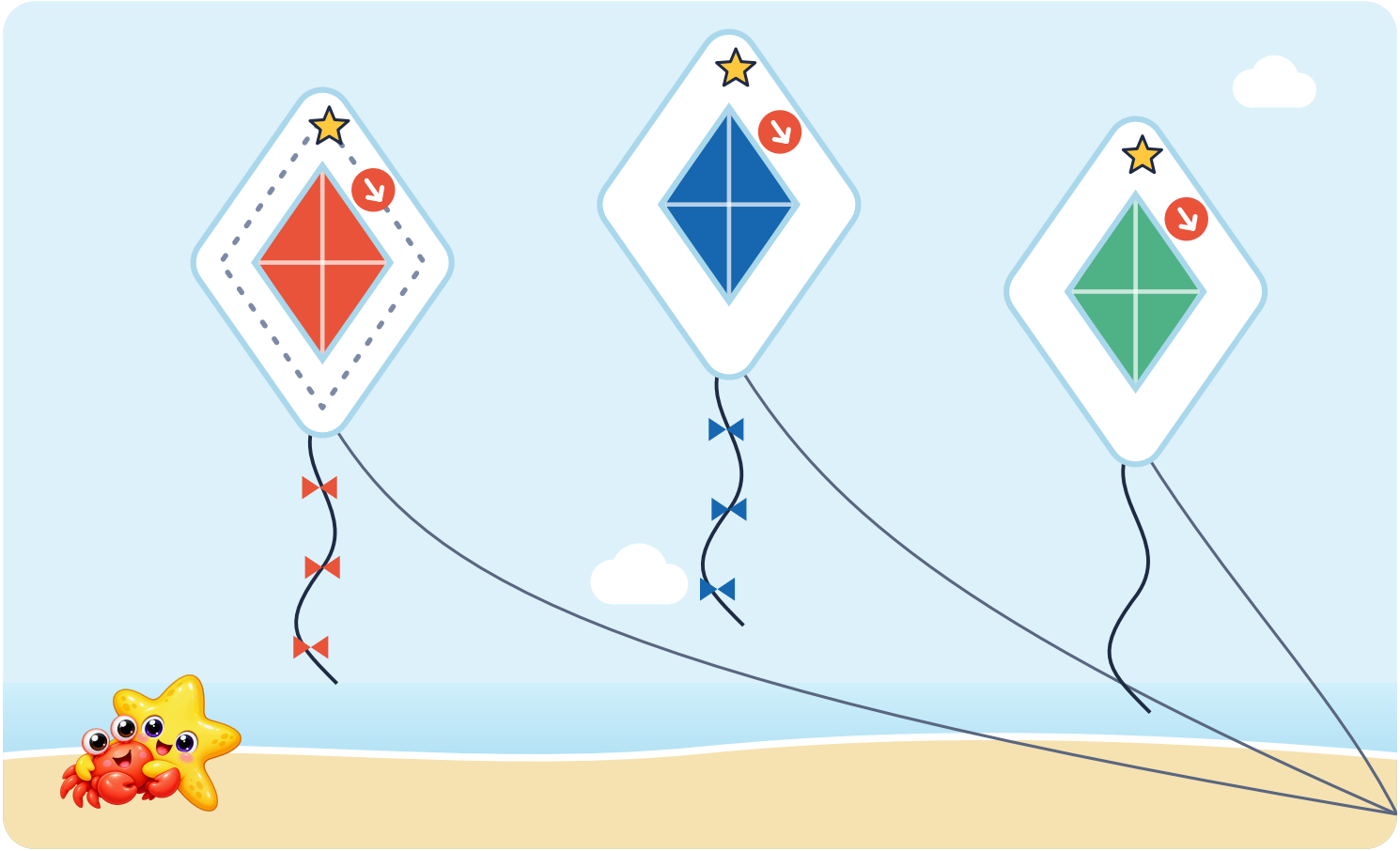
Date



23 A girl on the beach is flying a kite high in the sky. "That's the way to the sky!" says Twinkle. Kites fly because the wind lifts them up. Trace the diamonds to finish the kites.

Draw a bow on the kite's tail.

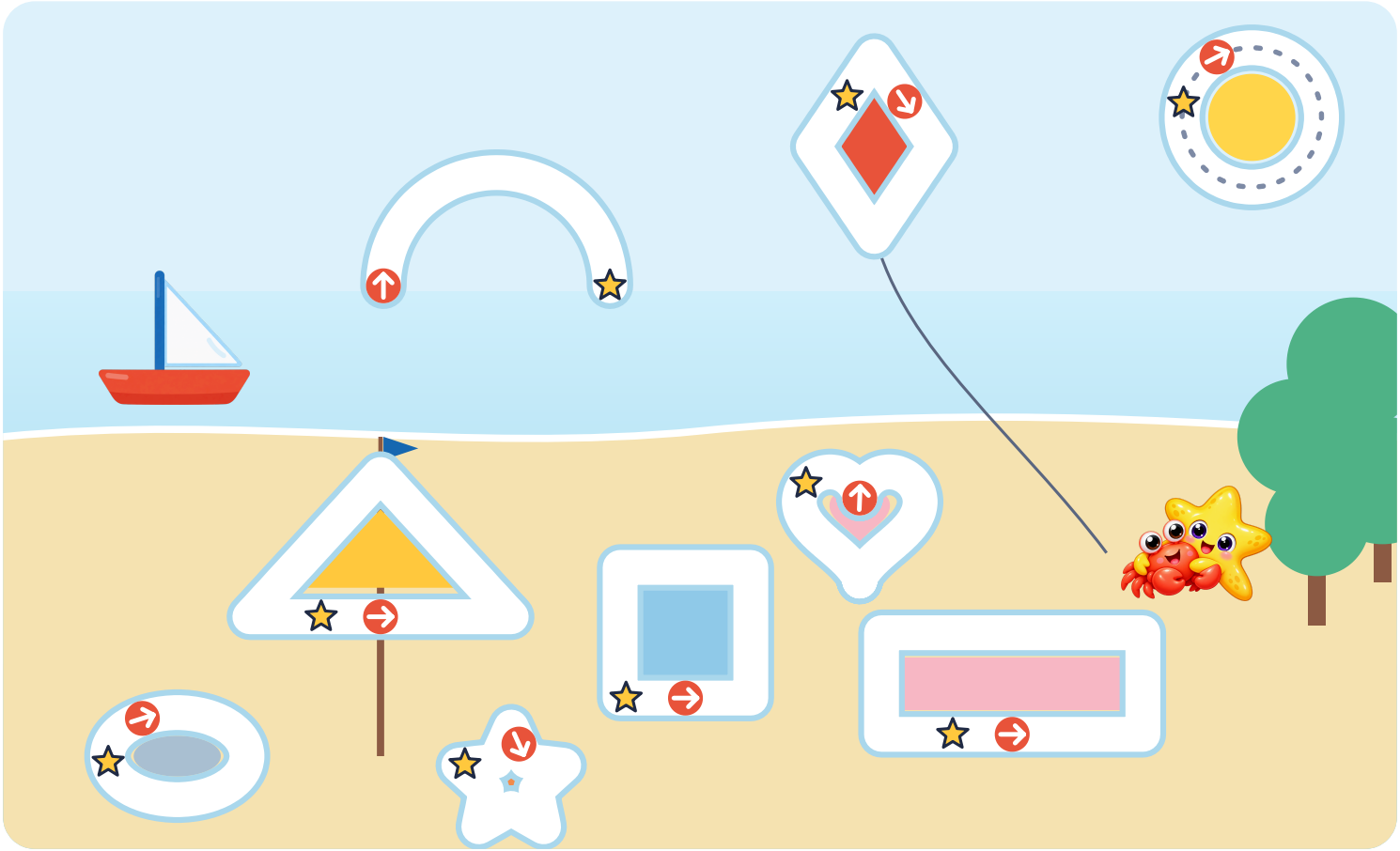
Date



24 At the end of the beach, Denny sees a forest full of tall trees. "To reach the sky, we have to find the tallest hill," Denny says. Before they go, can you find all the shapes? Trace every shape on the beach.

Count the triangles on the page.

Date

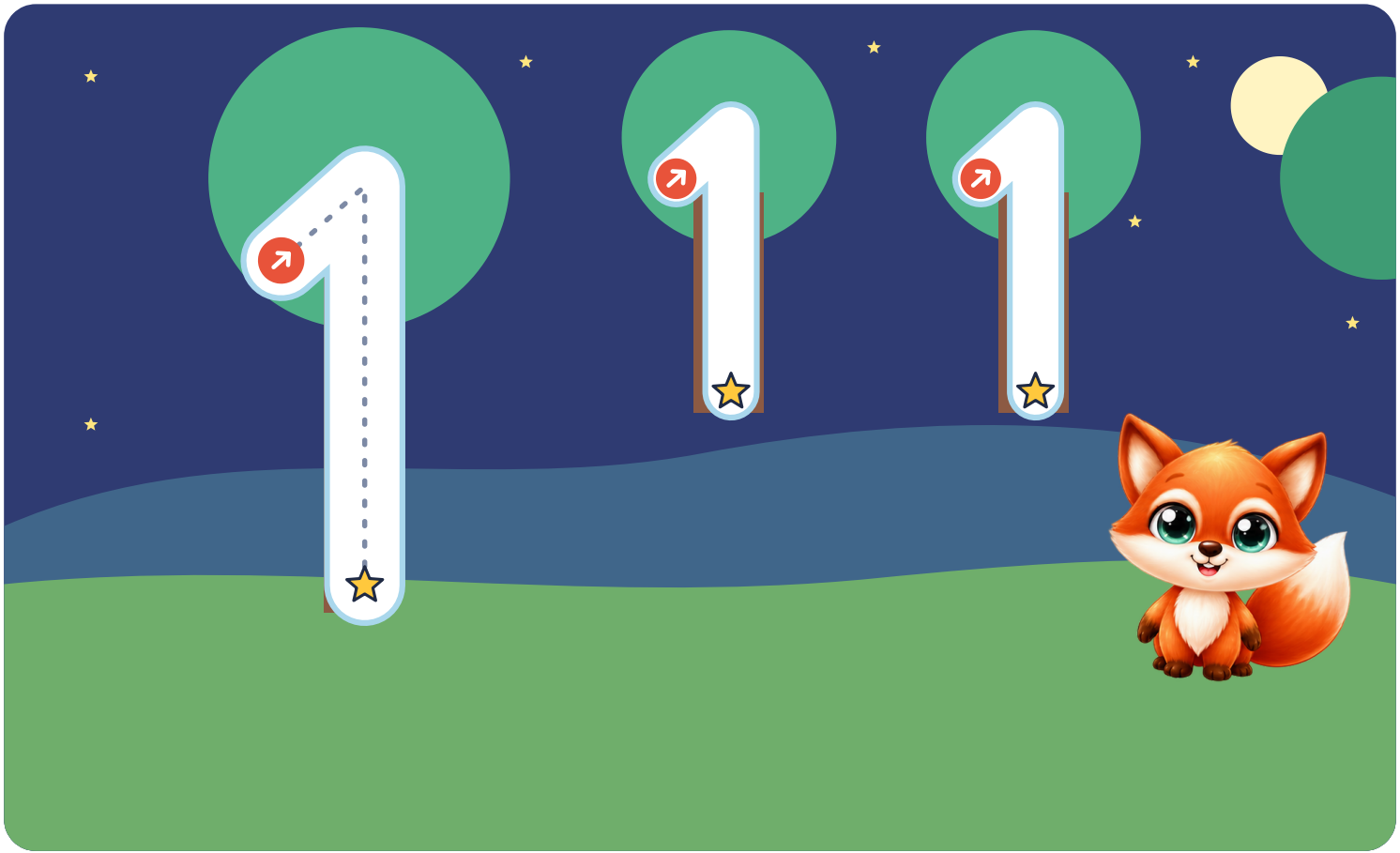


25

Night is falling when Denny reaches the forest. A bushy orange tail swishes behind a tree. It's Finn the fox! Foxes wrap their fluffy tails around themselves like a blanket to stay warm. Trace the number 1, then count the fox.

Find the moon peeking through the trees.

Date



26

Something prickly rolls out from under a leaf. Two little hedgehogs say hello! Hedgehogs curl up into a spiky ball when they feel scared. Trace the number 2, then count the hedgehogs.

Circle the hedgehog that is curled into a ball.

Date

27

"The tallest hill is on the other side of the forest," says Finn. "Follow the butterflies!" Butterflies taste with their feet! Trace the number 3 on each butterfly's wings, then count the butterflies.

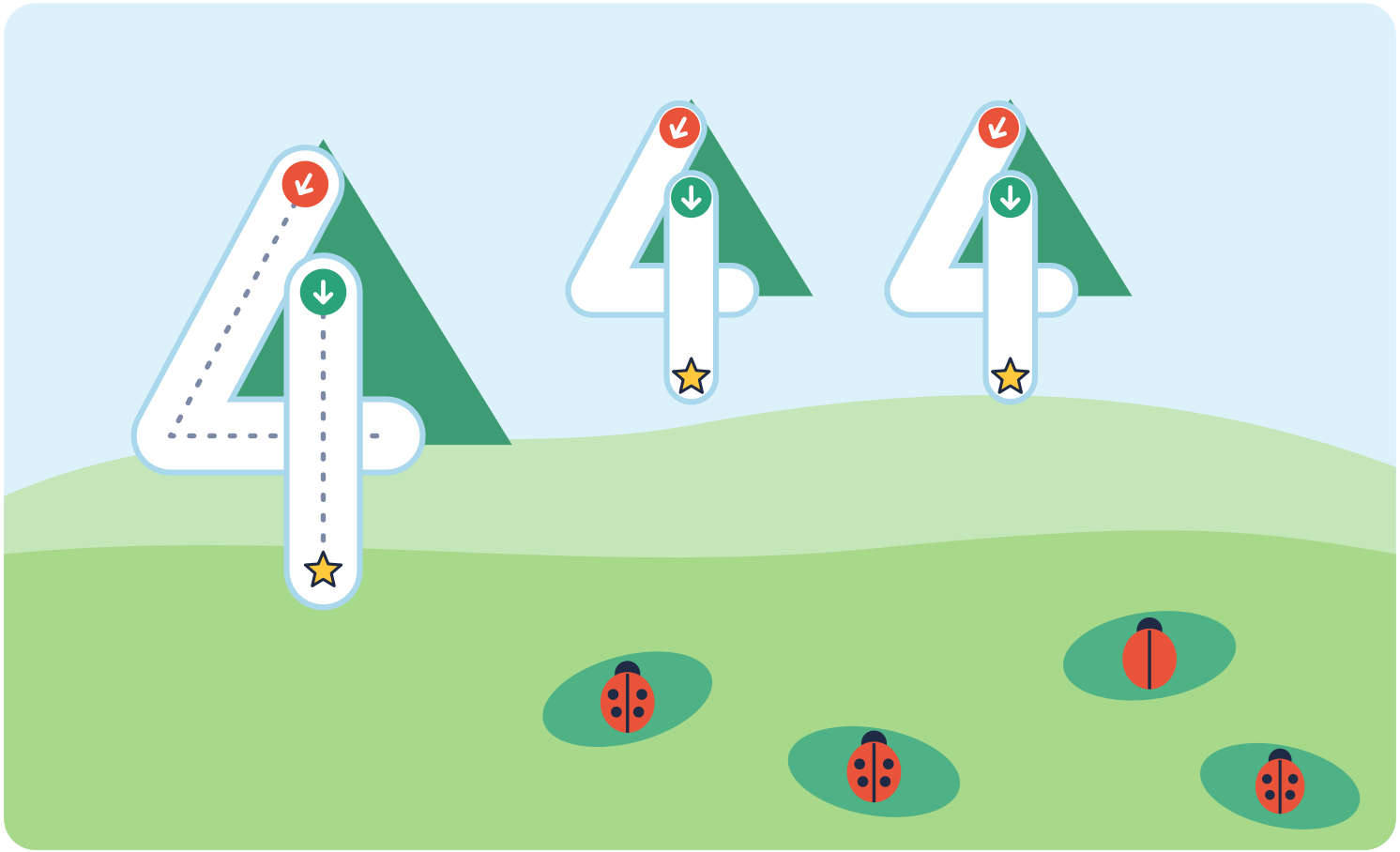
Find the two butterflies that match.

Date

28 Ladybugs are resting on the leaves. Ladybugs help gardens by eating tiny bugs that hurt plants. Trace the number 4, then count the ladybugs.

Draw some spots on the ladybug that has none.

Date



29

A busy squirrel is collecting acorns. Squirrels bury acorns in the ground to eat in winter, and sometimes they forget, so new trees grow! Trace the number 5, then count the acorns.

Find where the squirrel is hiding.

Date

30

Denny hears "ribbit, ribbit" by the pond. Frogs start life as tiny tadpoles that swim like fish. Trace the number 6, then count the frogs.

Can you find a tadpole in the water?

Date

31 Mushrooms are popping up all along the forest path. Mushrooms grow best in cool, shady, damp places. Trace the number 7 on each big mushroom, then count all the mushrooms.

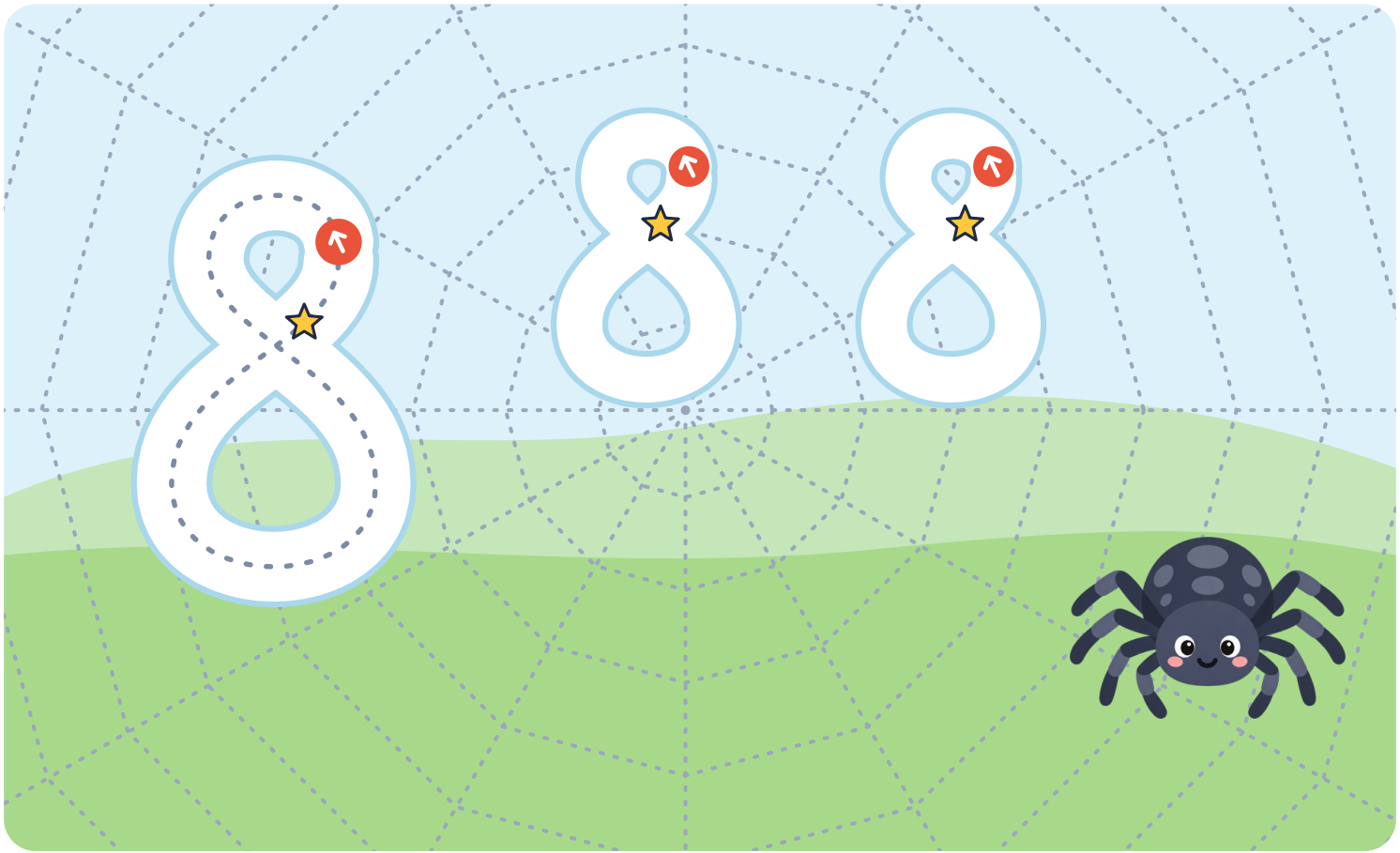
Which mushroom has white spots? Color it.

Date

32 A friendly spider waves hello from her web. Spiders have 8 legs, just like Ollie has 8 arms. Trace the number 8, then count the spider's legs.

Trace the silky lines of the spider web.

Date



33

Night falls again, and the forest begins to sparkle. A tiny light zips up to Denny. It's Glow the firefly! Fireflies make their own light, and Twinkle glows a little brighter next to her new friend. Trace the number 9, then count the fireflies.

Which firefly is Glow? Circle Glow.

Date

34

"I have an idea!" says Finn. "We can build a rocket to fly Twinkle home!" Everyone gathers pinecones to build it. Trace the number 10, then count the pinecones.

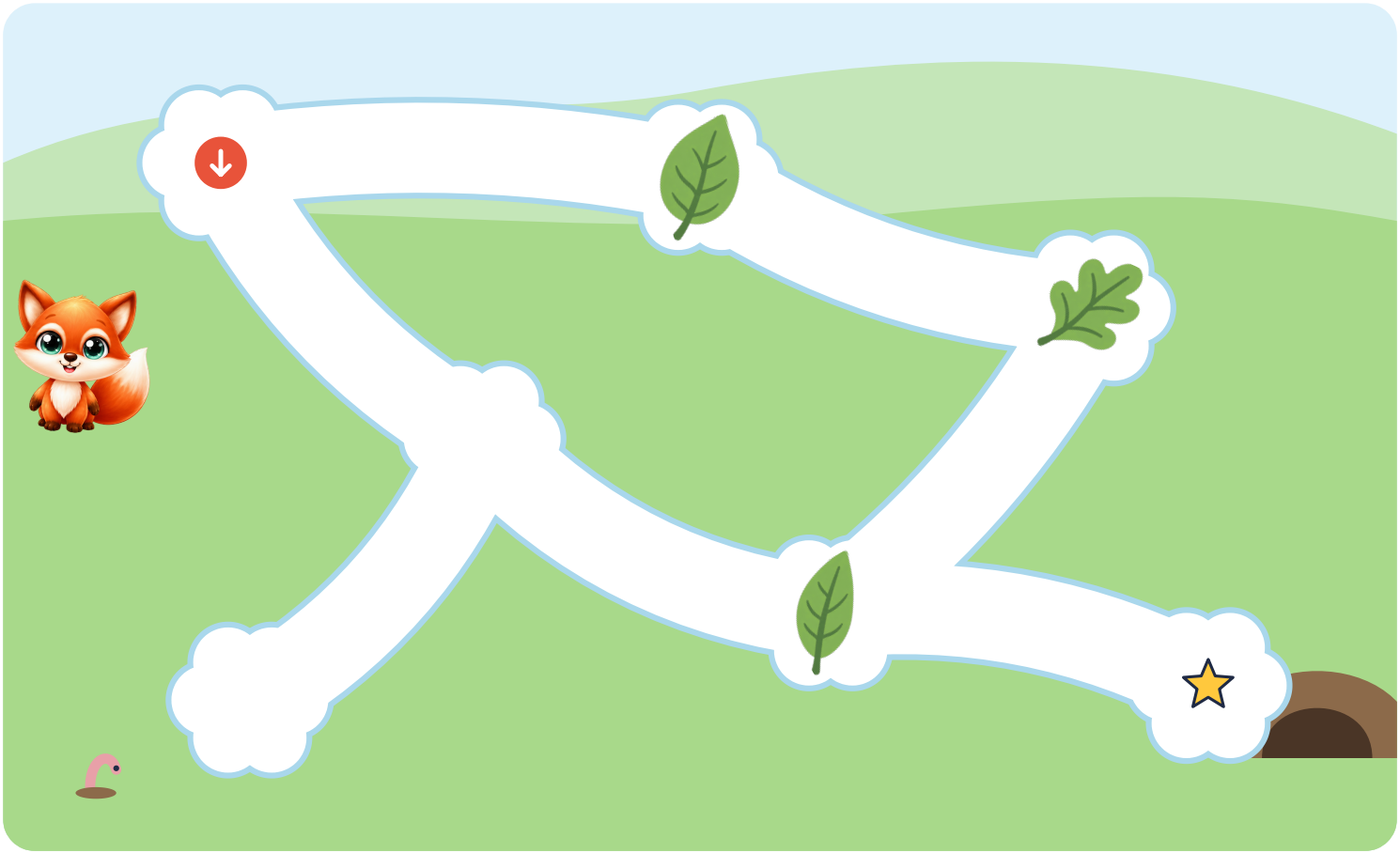
Count backward from 10 to 1, like a rocket countdown!

Date

35 Time for our first maze! Remember, use your pencil so you can erase and try again. Finn needs soft leaves to line the rocket seat. Draw a line that collects all the leaves, then help Finn get back home to his den.

Find the worm peeking out of the ground.

Date

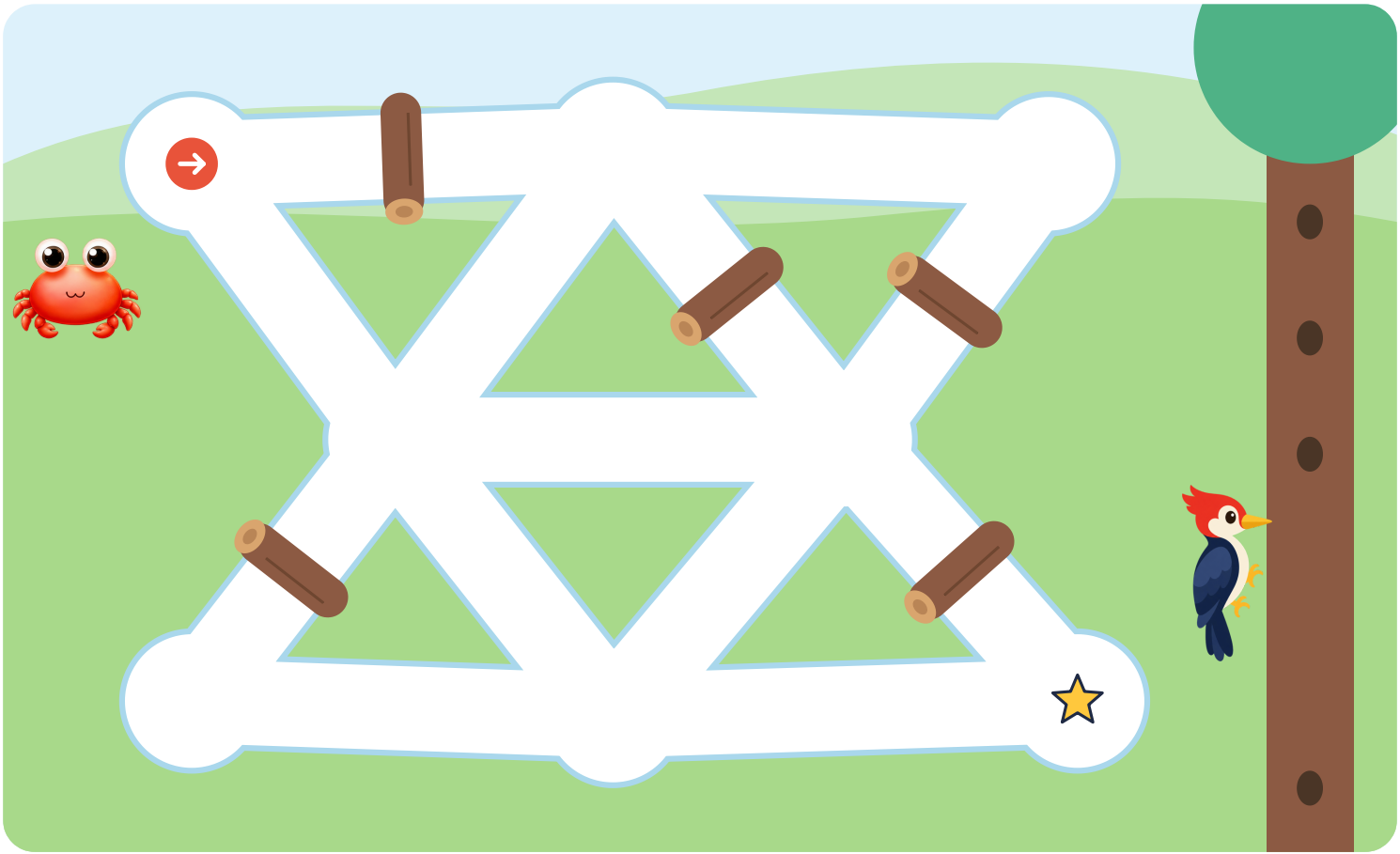


36

The rocket needs a strong base. A woodpecker offers a sturdy piece of bark. Woodpeckers tap on trees with their beaks to find bugs to eat. Help Denny find the way to the woodpecker's tree. Watch out for fallen logs!

Count the holes in the tree.

Date

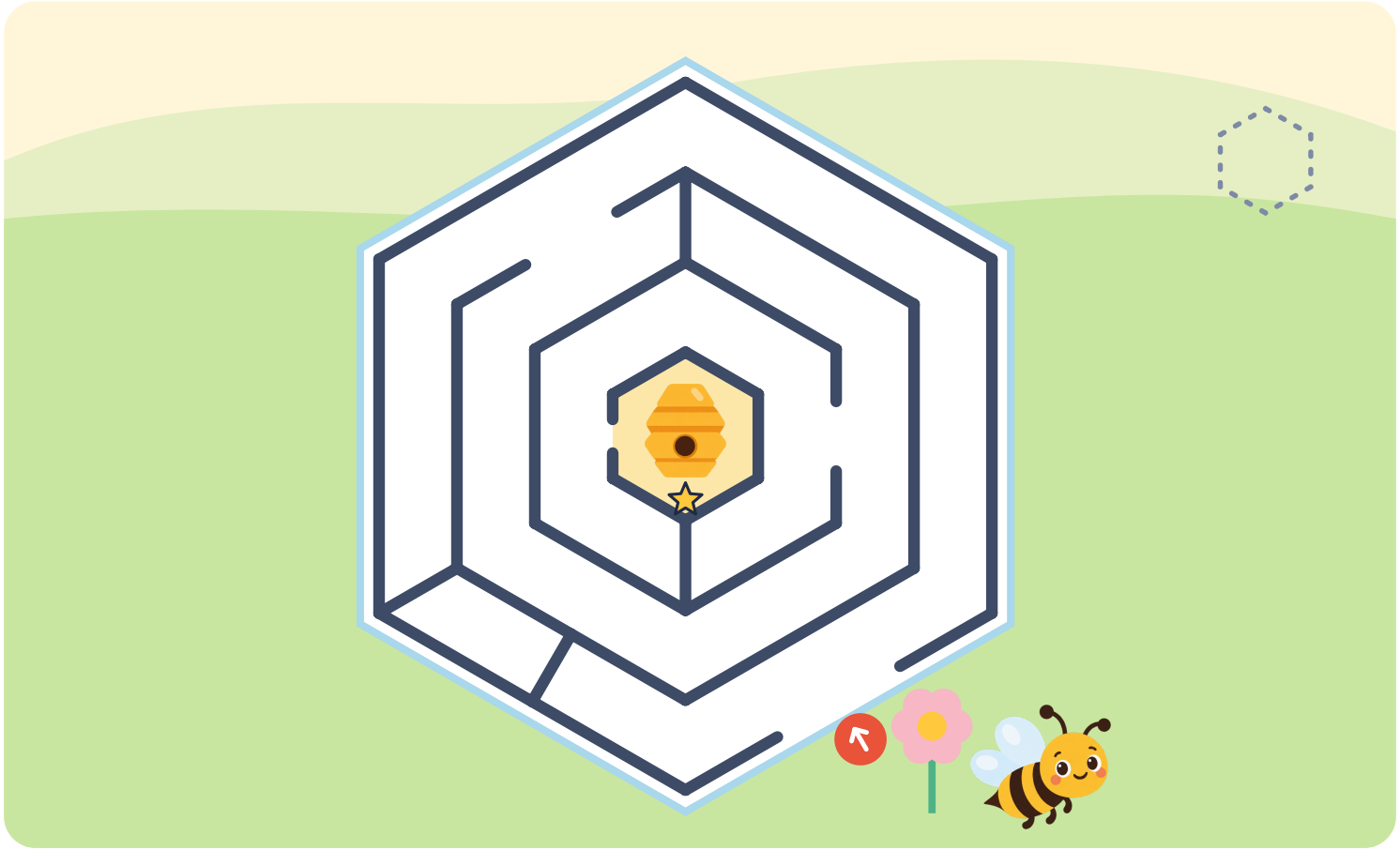


37

Bees are buzzing around their hive. Bees make honey from the sweet nectar inside flowers. They'll share a little honey to help glue the rocket pieces together. Help the bee fly from the flower all the way into the middle of the hive.

A shape with 6 sides is called a hexagon. Can you trace one?

Date

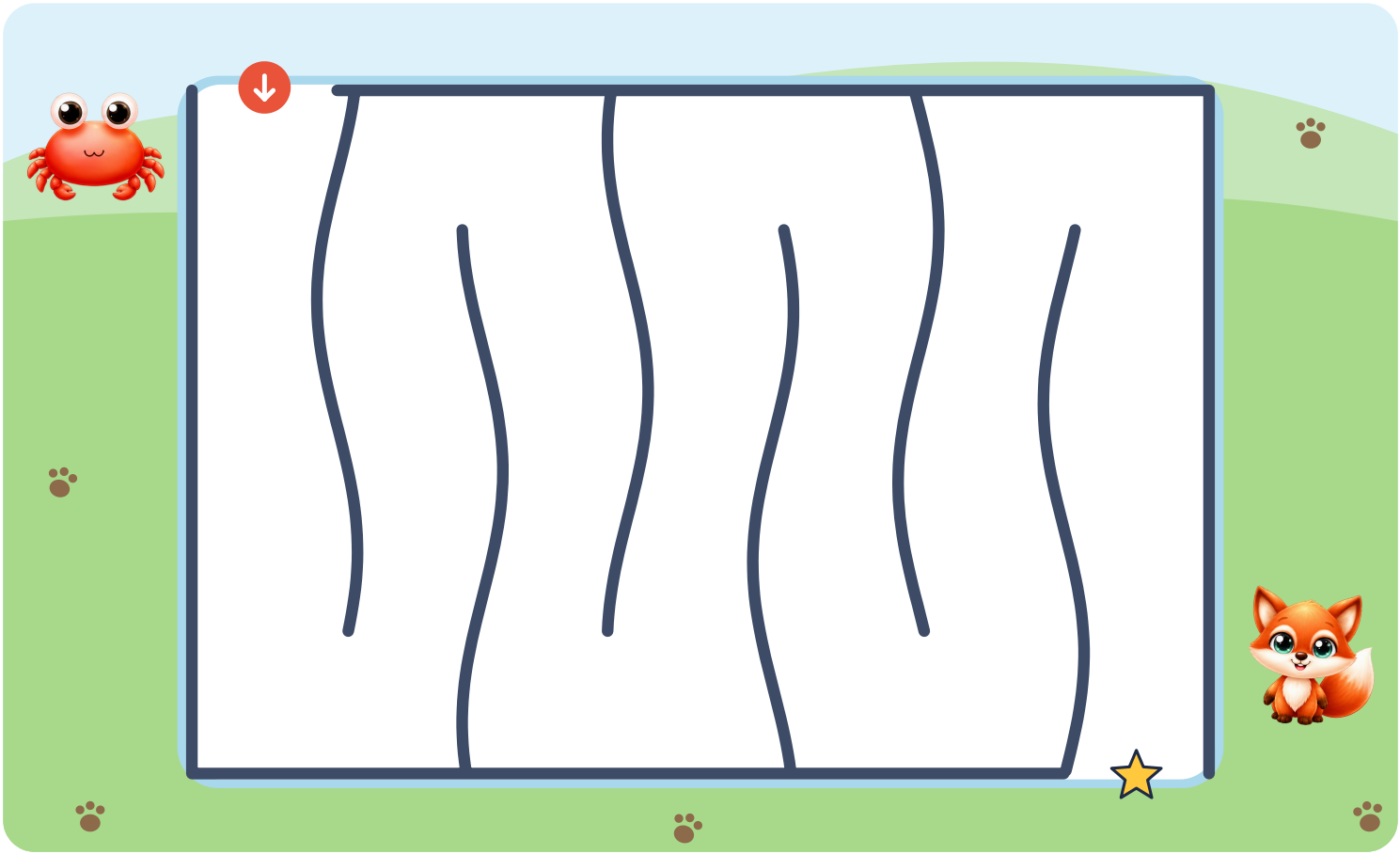


38

Finn runs ahead to find the path up the hill. Foxes have amazing hearing and can hear a mouse squeak from far away! Help Denny follow Finn through the trees.

Find Finn's paw prints on the ground.

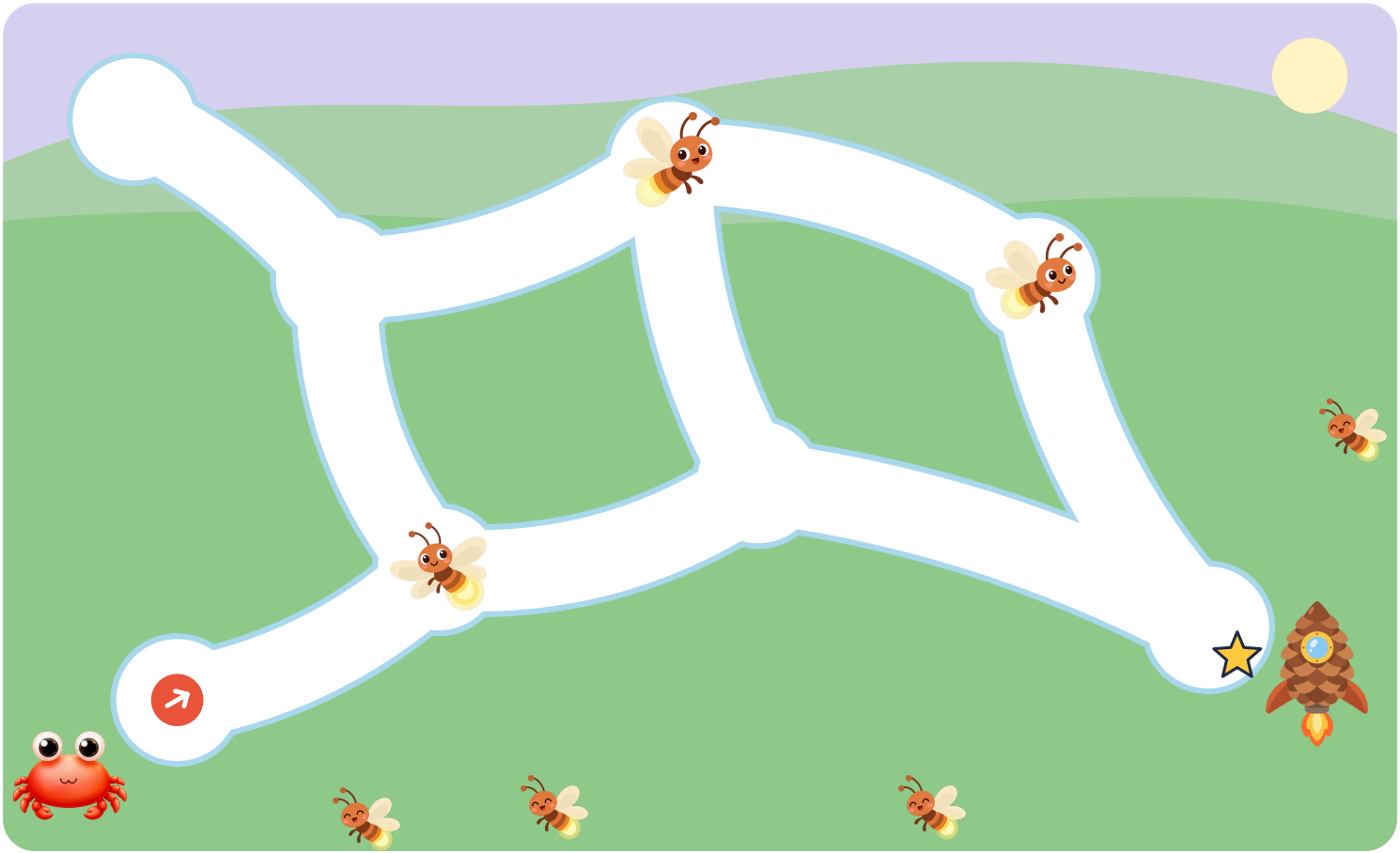
Date



39 The rocket needs light to fly at night. Glow calls the whole firefly family to come along and shine! Draw a path that collects all 3 fireflies and ends at the rocket.

How many fireflies are left in the grass?

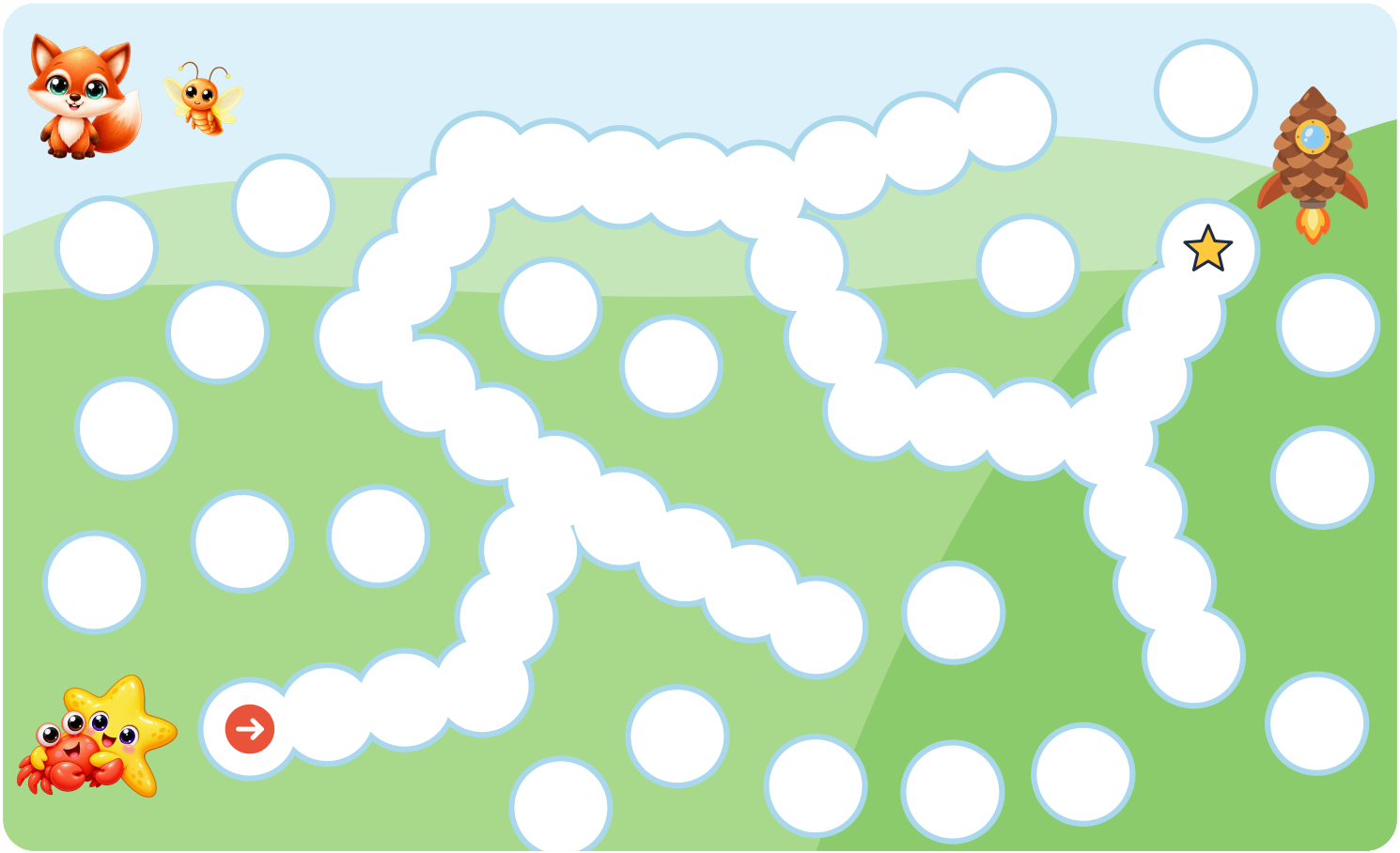
Date



40 The rocket is ready on top of the tallest hill! Finn and Glow hug Denny goodbye. "Take care of Twinkle!" Help Denny and Twinkle hop up to the rocket. Only step on stones that touch each other!

Can you find Finn and Glow waving goodbye?

Date

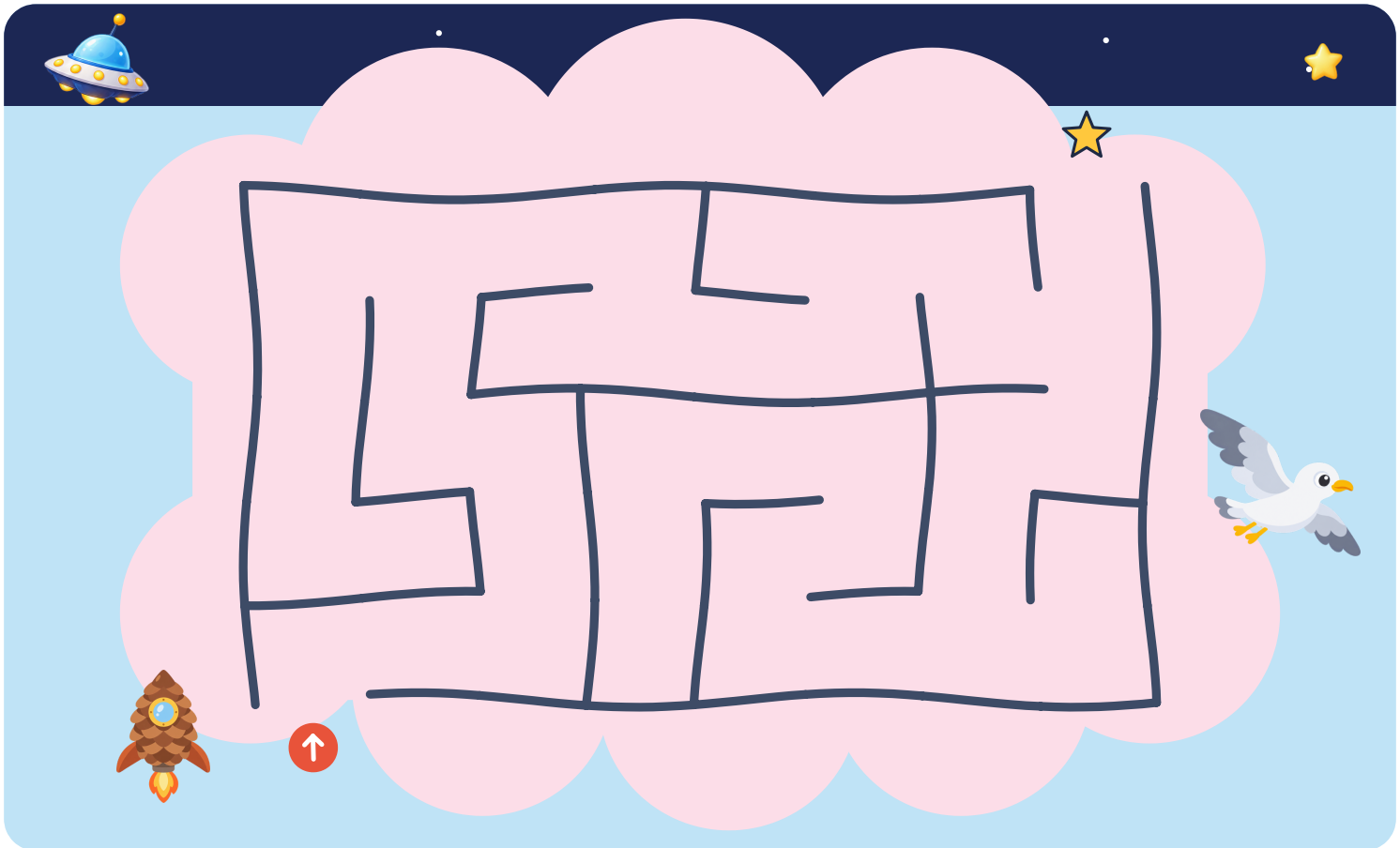


41

3, 2, 1... blast off! The rocket zooms up through the fluffy clouds. Clouds are made of tiny drops of water floating in the air. Help the rocket find its way through the clouds to the dark sky above.

Find the bird flying next to the rocket.

Date



42

The rocket lands softly on the moon. The moon doesn't make its own light; it shines because the sun lights it up. Help Denny find his way around the craters and back to the rocket in the middle.

Count the craters on the moon.

Date

43 Twinkle's light is still dim. "Sparkly stardust will help me shine," she says. Draw a path that collects all 5 bits of stardust and ends at the rocket. Twinkle grows a little brighter!

One stardust sparkle is a different color. Circle it.

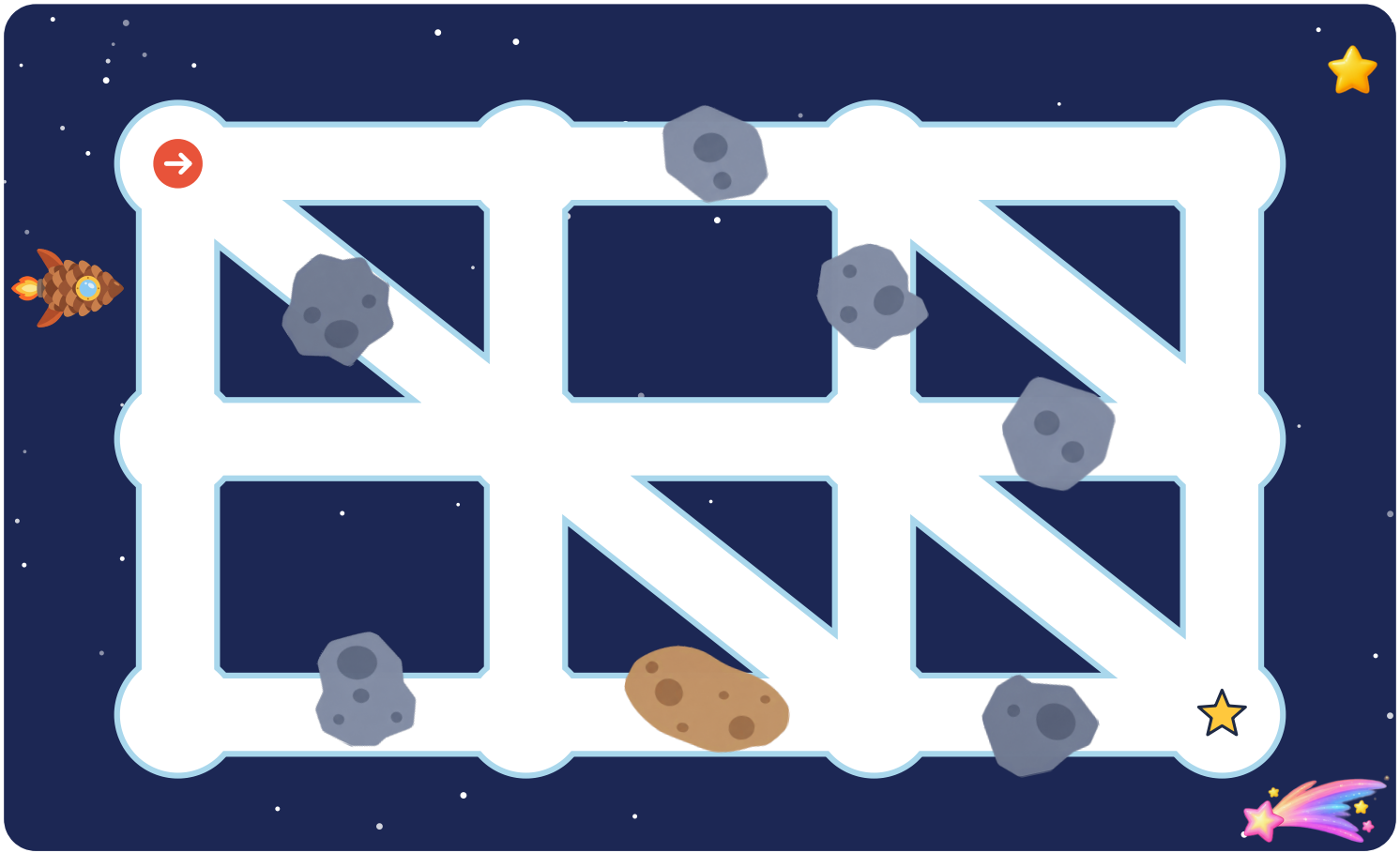
Date

44

Watch out, space rocks! Asteroids are big rocks floating in space. Guide the rocket through the asteroid field without touching any rocks.

One asteroid looks like a potato. Can you find it?

Date

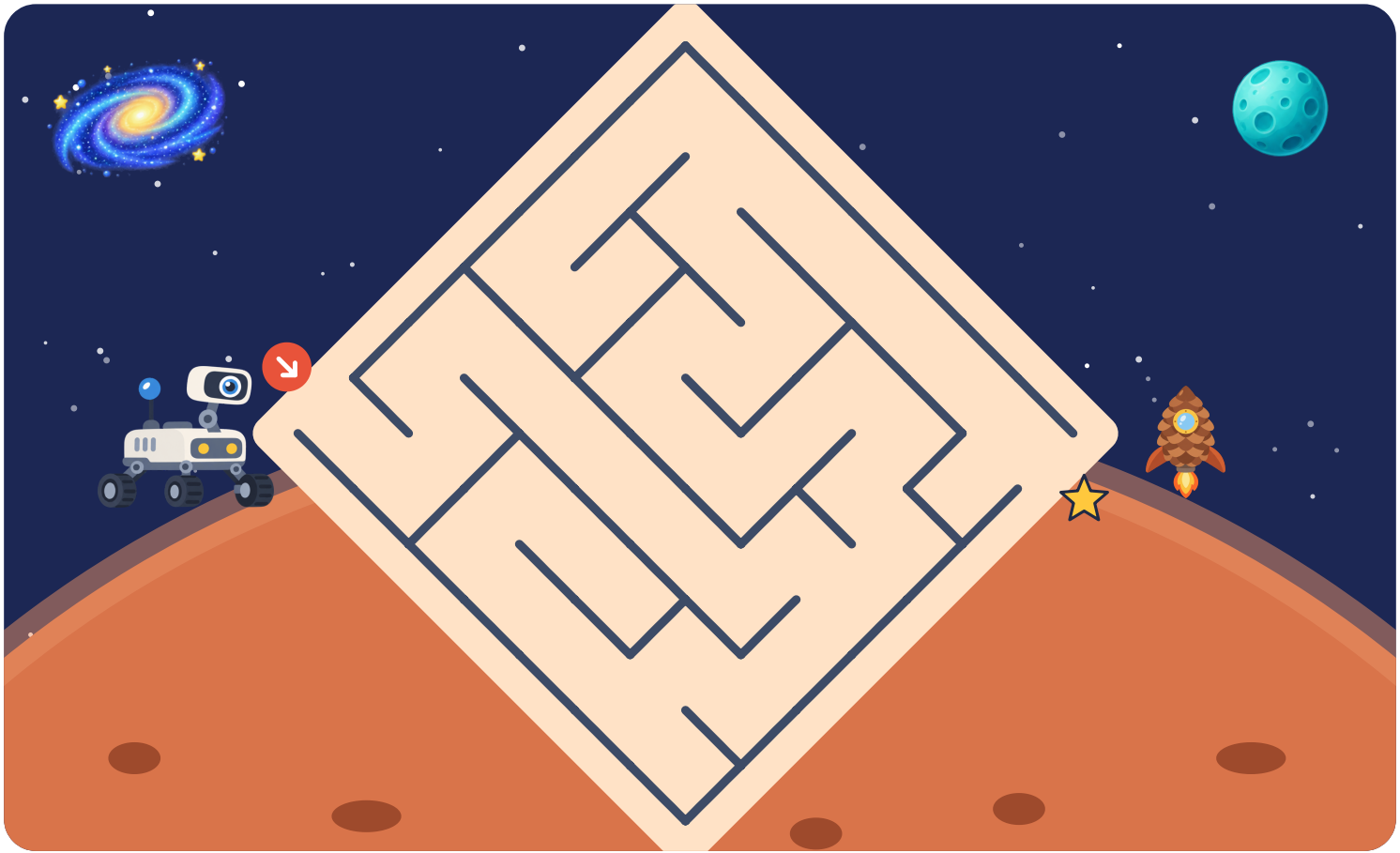


45

Next they fly past a red planet called Mars. Mars looks red because its dust is rusty, like an old nail. Help the little rover drive across Mars to the rocket.

Count the rocks on Mars.

Date

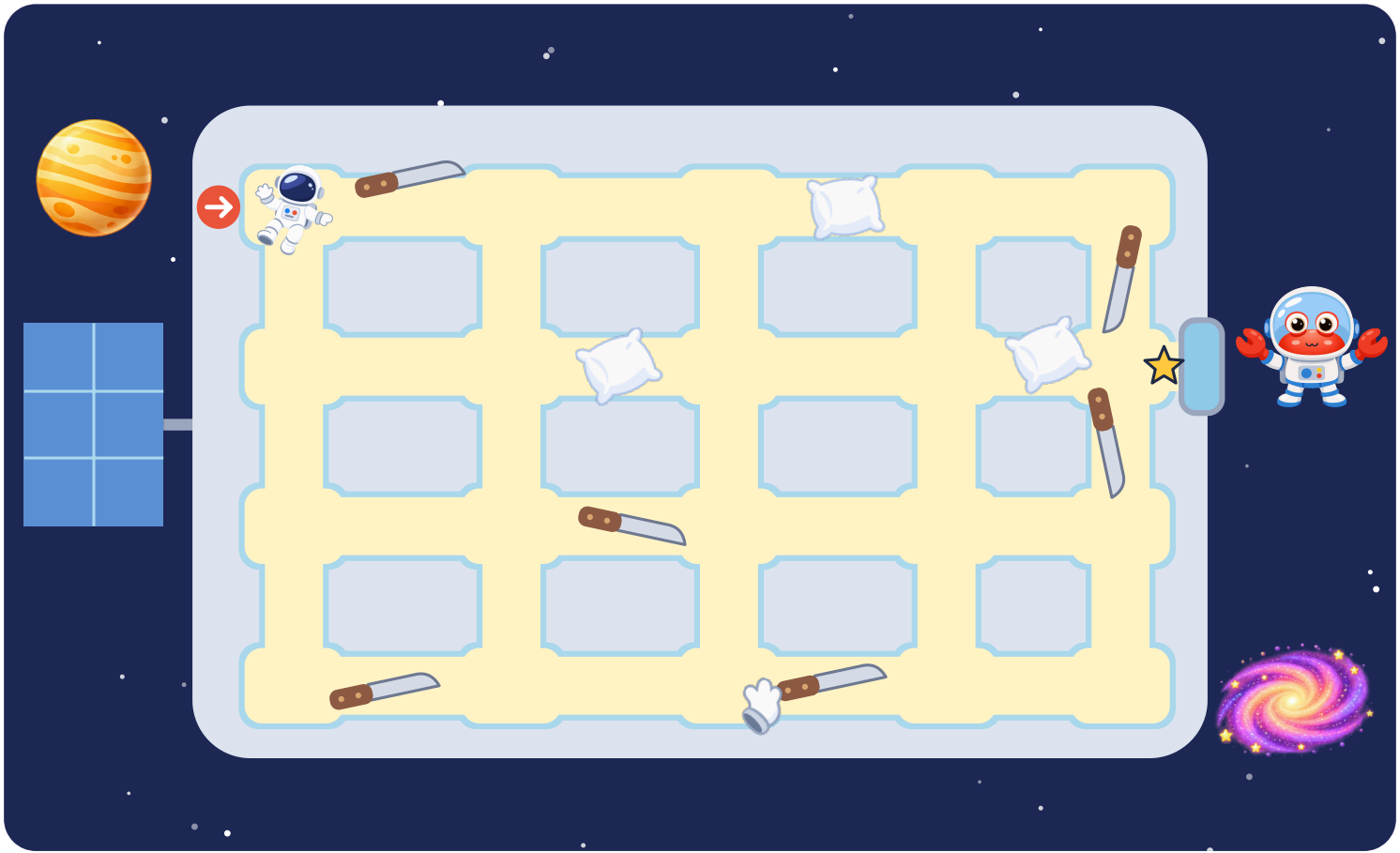


46

Denny spots a space station with astronauts inside. In space there is almost no gravity, so astronauts float, and so does everything else! Help the astronaut float to the window to wave at Denny. Stay away from the flying knives, but floating past soft pillows is fine.

Find the astronaut's missing glove.

Date

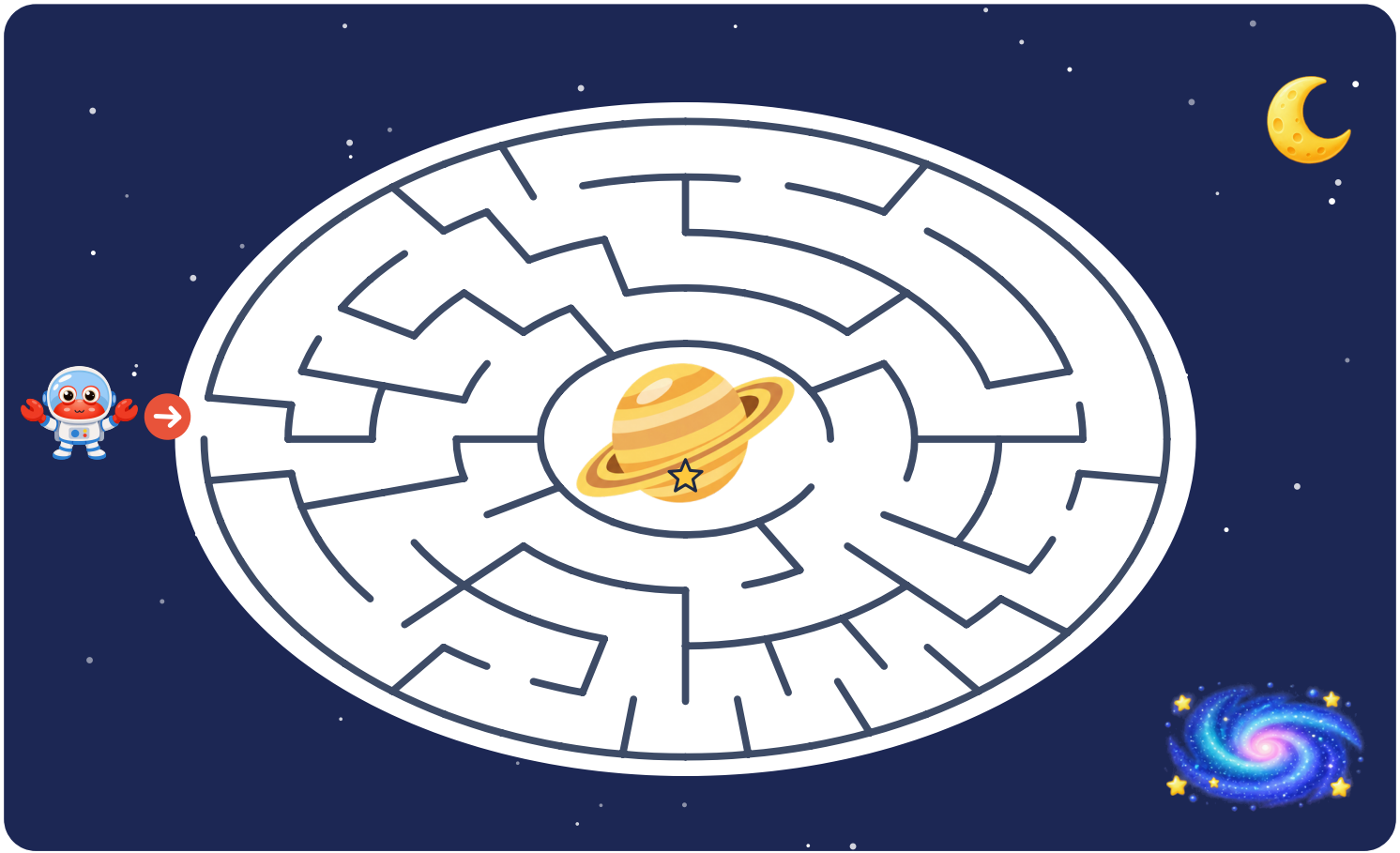


47

Wow, a planet with rings! Saturn's rings are made of ice and rock spinning around it. Find the way from the outside ring to the planet in the middle.

Color Saturn's rings.

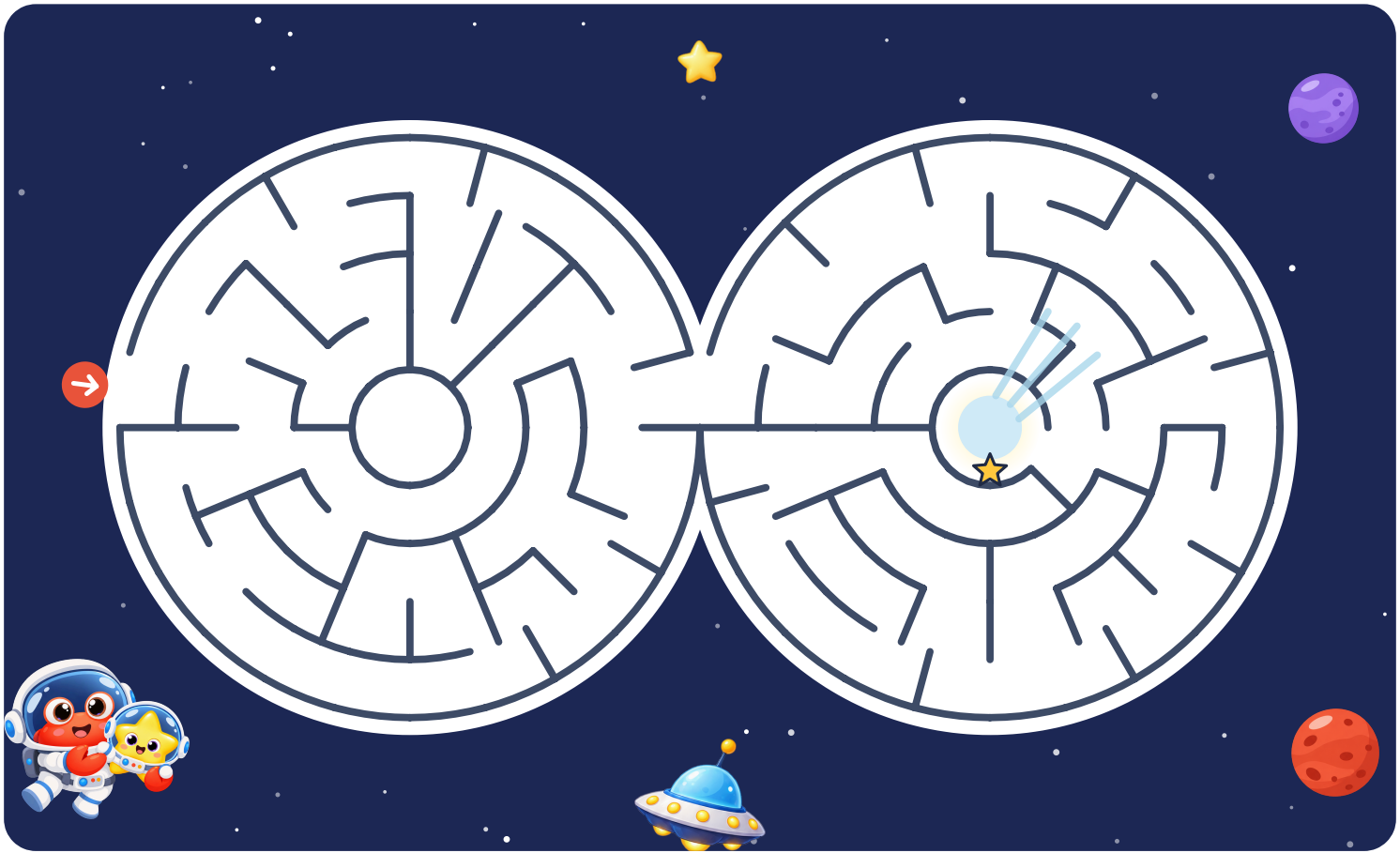
Date



48 A comet zooms past with a long, glowing tail. Comets are big balls of ice and dust. Find the way through both round mazes to catch up with the comet in the middle.

How many planets can you find on this page?

Date



49

Denny looks back and sees a round blue ball. It's Earth, his home! Earth looks blue because most of it is covered by oceans. Help the rocket fly around the planets to see Earth up close.

Point to the ocean where Denny lives.

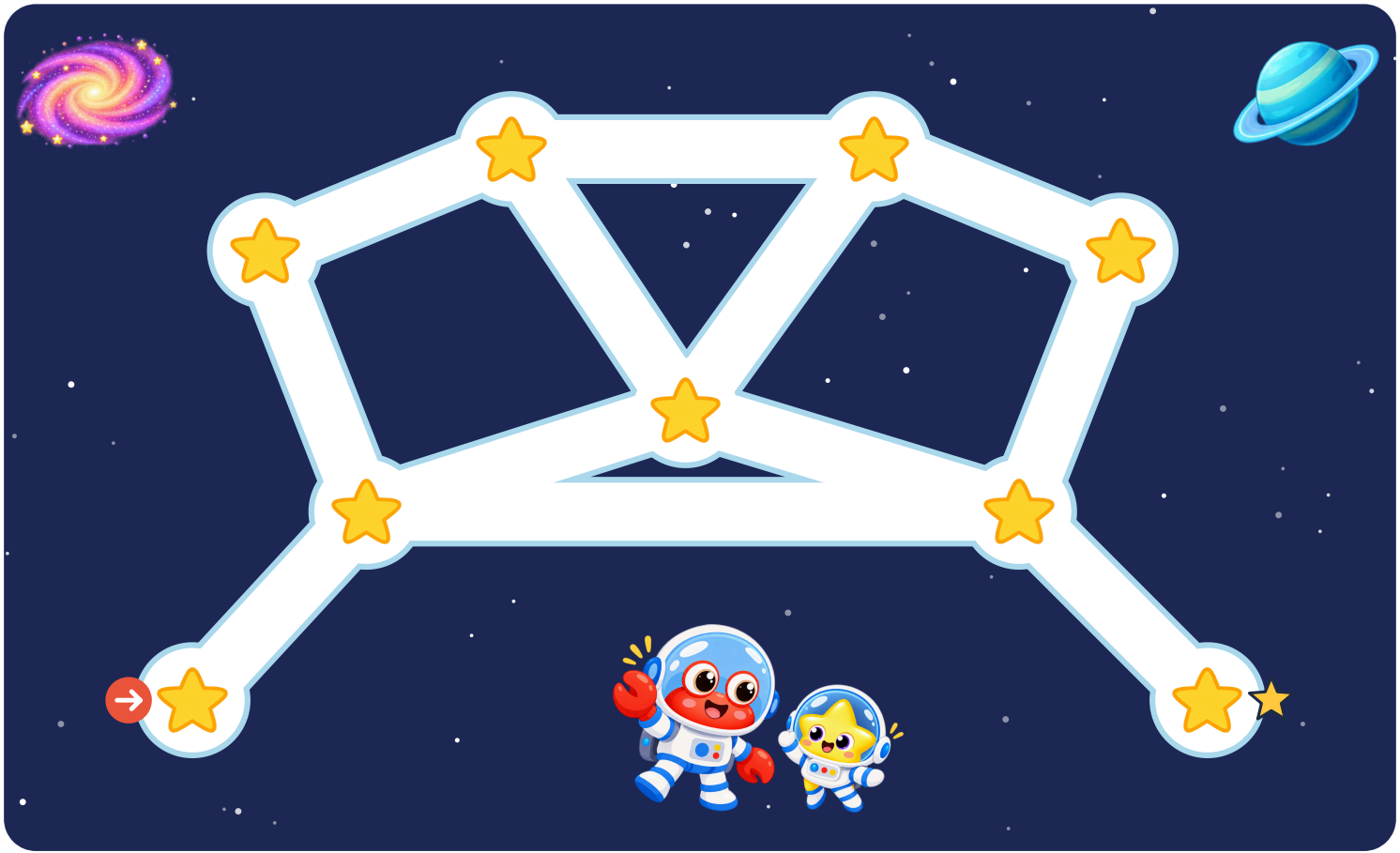
Date

50

"Look, my family!" Twinkle cheers. Groups of stars make pictures in the sky called constellations, and there's even one called the Crab! Collect all the stars in the constellation on your way to the end.

How many stars are in the Crab constellation?

Date

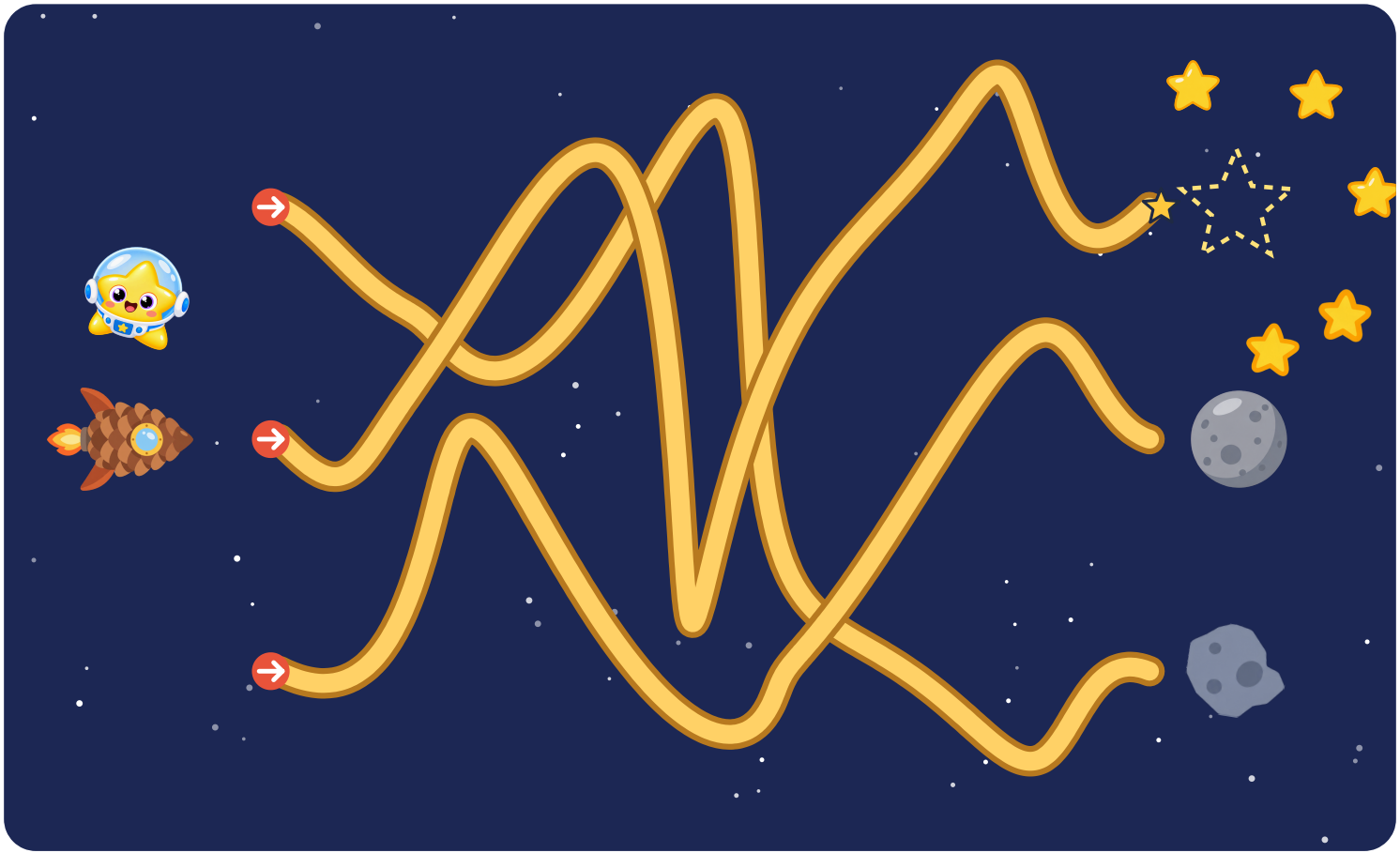


51

There's one empty spot in the sky where Twinkle belongs. Three paths lead from the rocket, but only one reaches her home. Which path is the right one? Trace it to find out.

Draw a smile on each star in the constellation.

Date

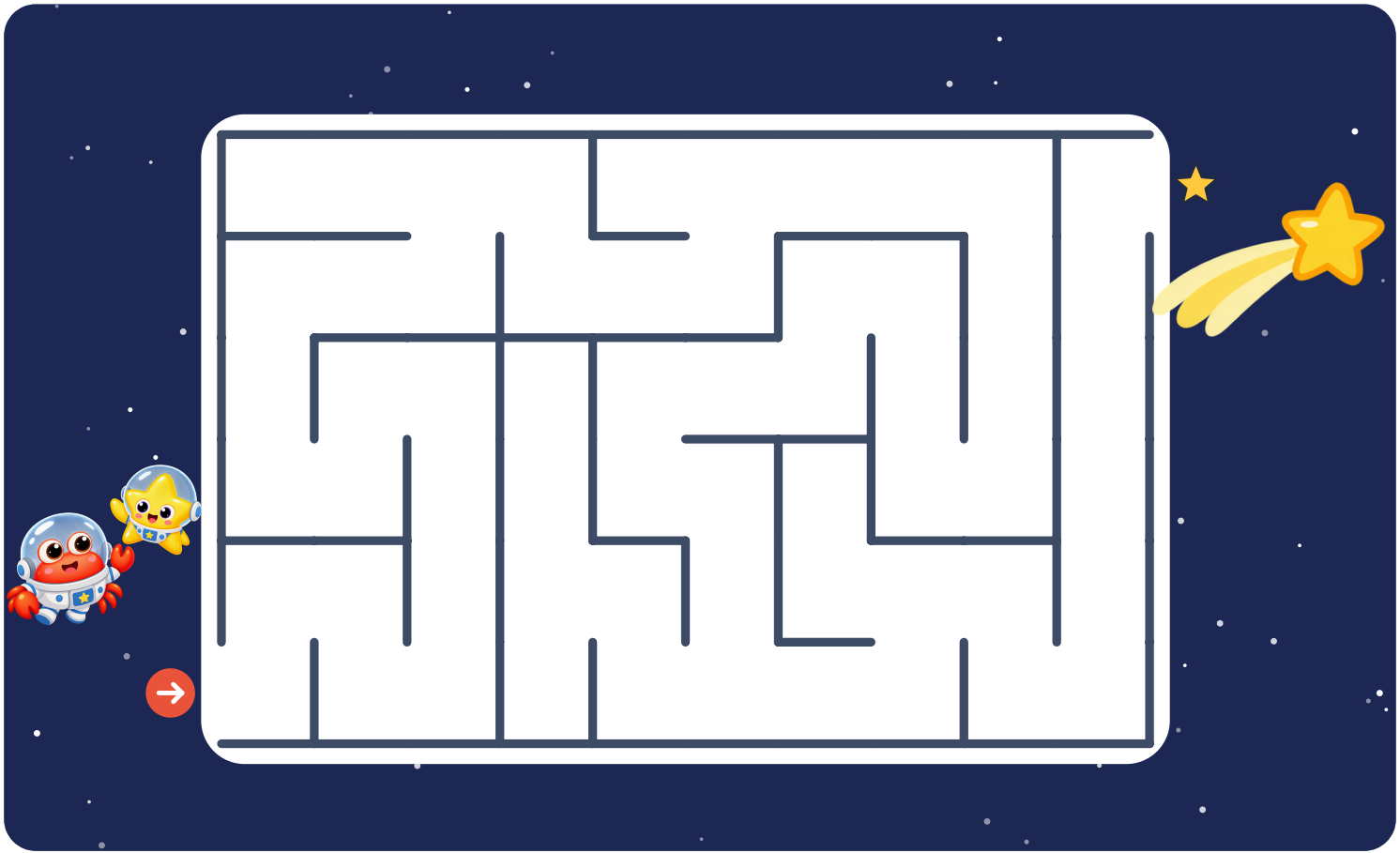


52

Twinkle is home, and she shines brighter than ever! "Thank you, Denny. You're my hero." Her sister, a shooting star, offers to carry Denny back to Earth. Help Denny reach the shooting star for his ride home.

Wave goodbye to Twinkle! Then draw more stars around her.

Date

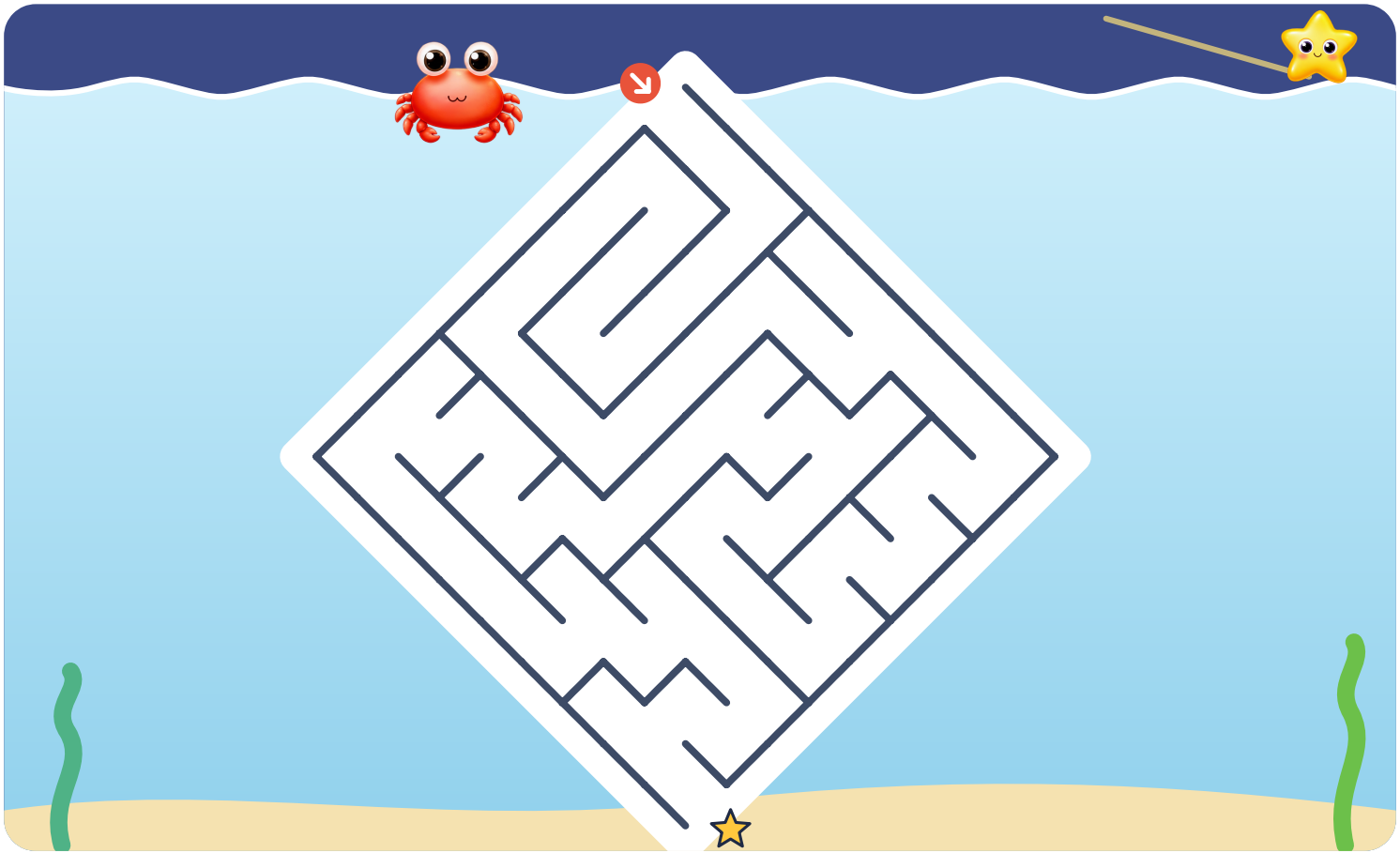


53

The shooting star swoops down and splash! Denny lands in the ocean, just like Twinkle did at the very start. These last mazes are the trickiest, so take your time and use your eraser when you need it. Help Denny find the way down through the maze to the sea floor.

Look up! Can you spot Twinkle shining in the sky?

Date

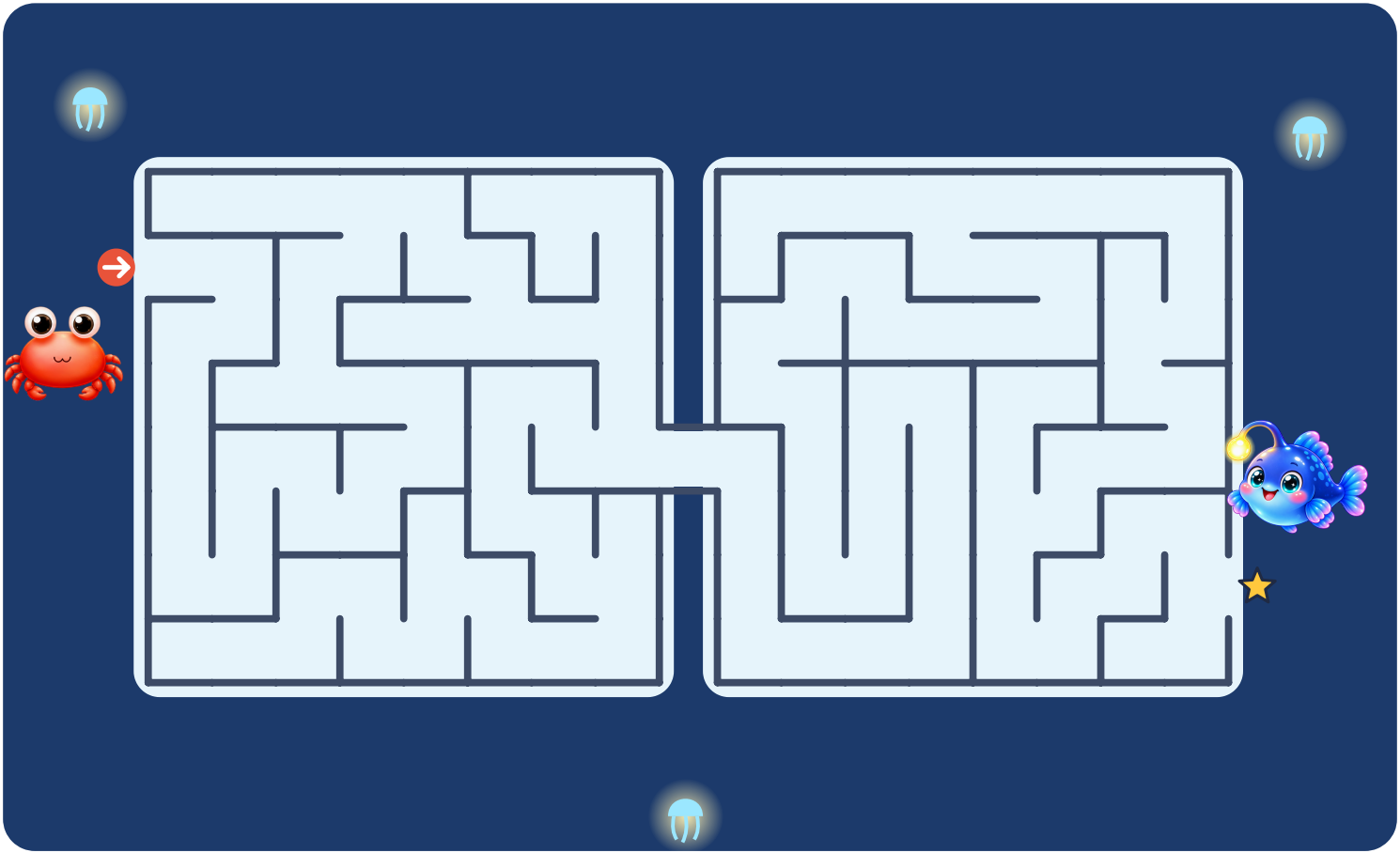


54

The deep sea is very dark because sunlight can't reach that far down. A little anglerfish swims by with a light on its head, like a tiny lantern! Swim through both dark mazes to reach the anglerfish and its light.

Find three glowing sea creatures.

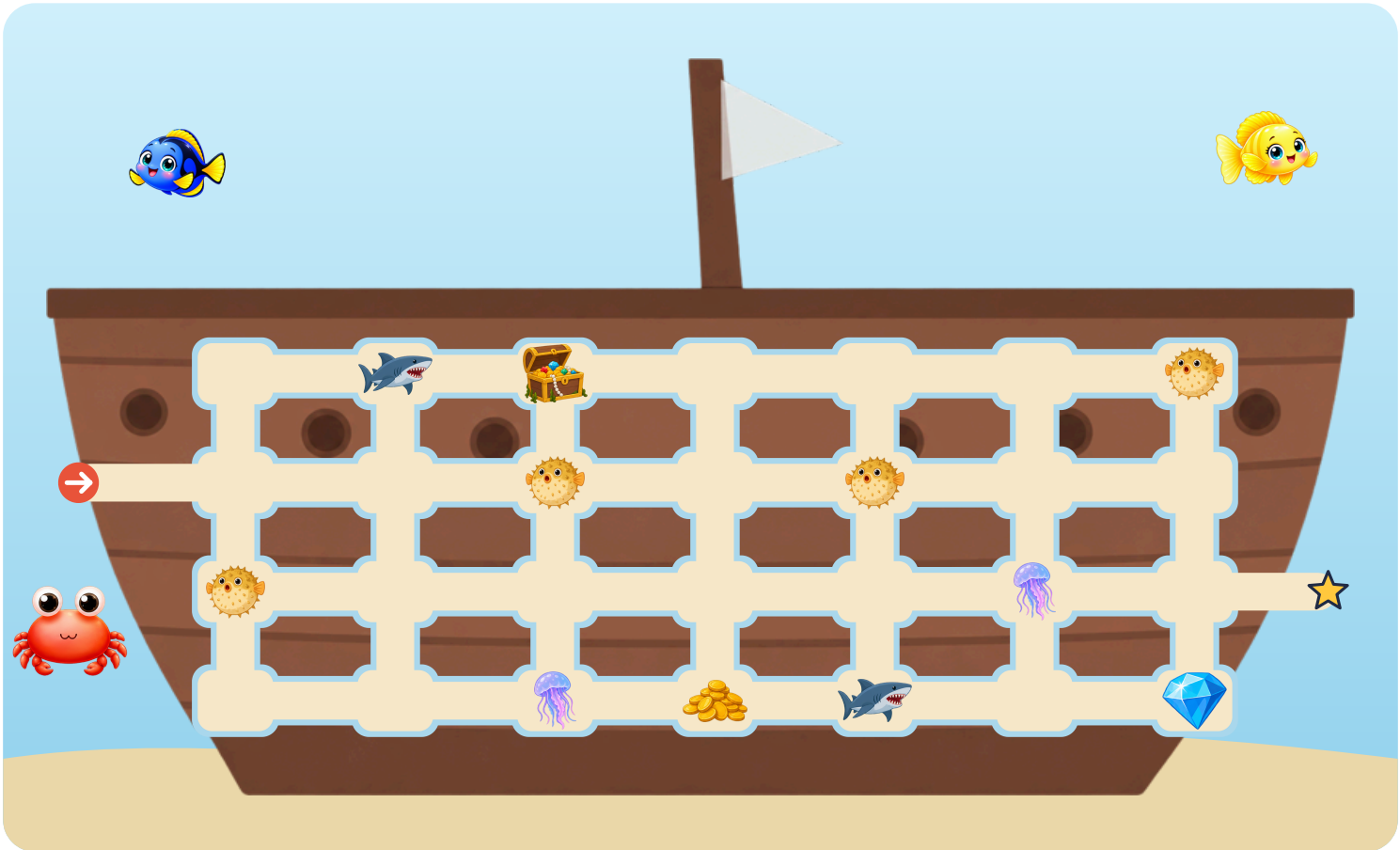
Date



55 Denny finds an old sunken ship resting on the sea floor. Collect all 3 treasures on your way through the ship: the chest, the gold coins and the shiny gem. Stay out of the rooms with pufferfish, sharks and stinging jellyfish!

Which danger do you see the most: pufferfish, sharks or jellyfish?

Date

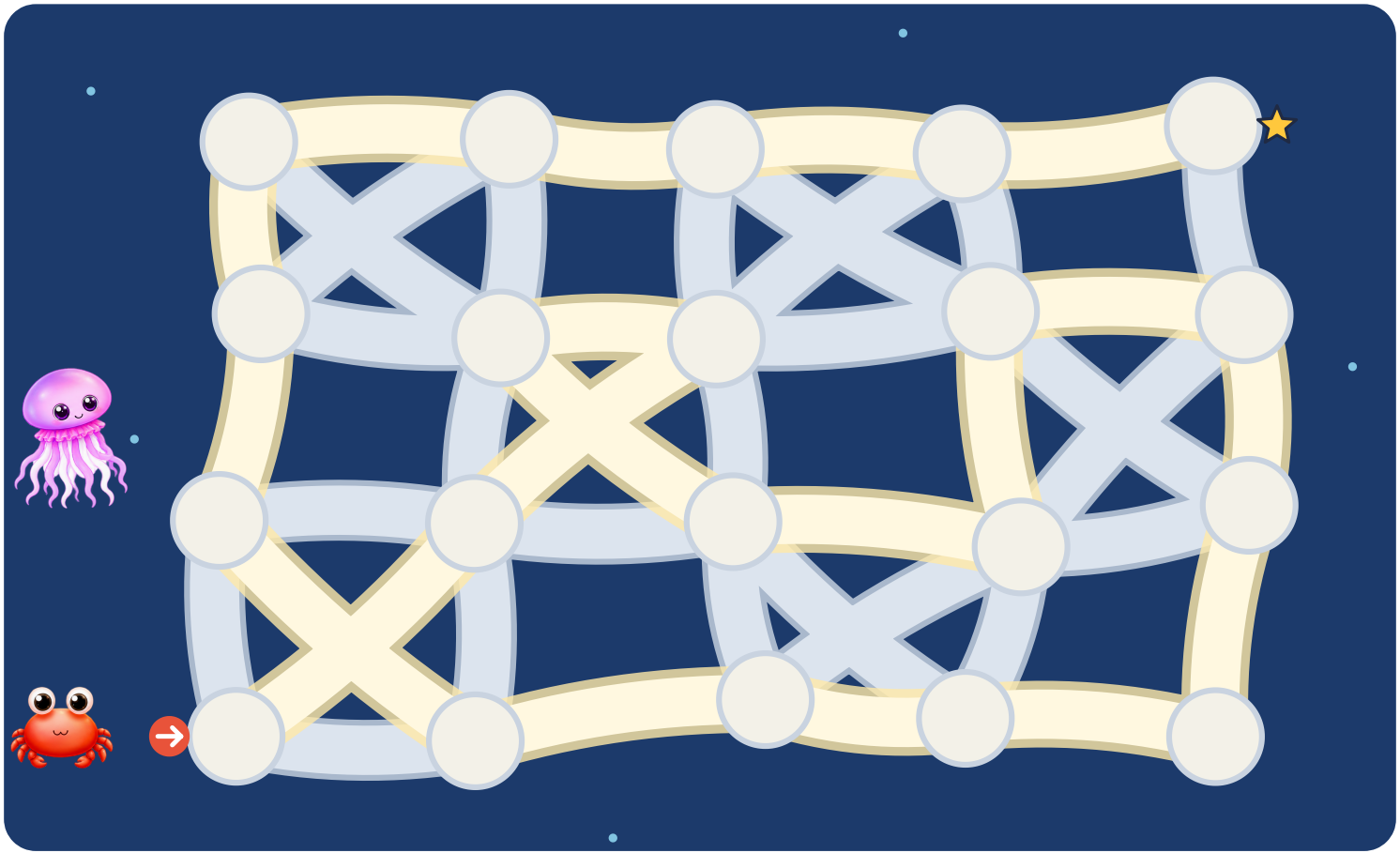


56

Pearl the jellyfish floats over, glowing softly. "Denny, you're back! Follow my light." Help Pearl lead Denny through the maze, but only along the glowing paths. Look closely: the glowing paths are a little yellow!

Count Pearl's wiggly tentacles.

Date

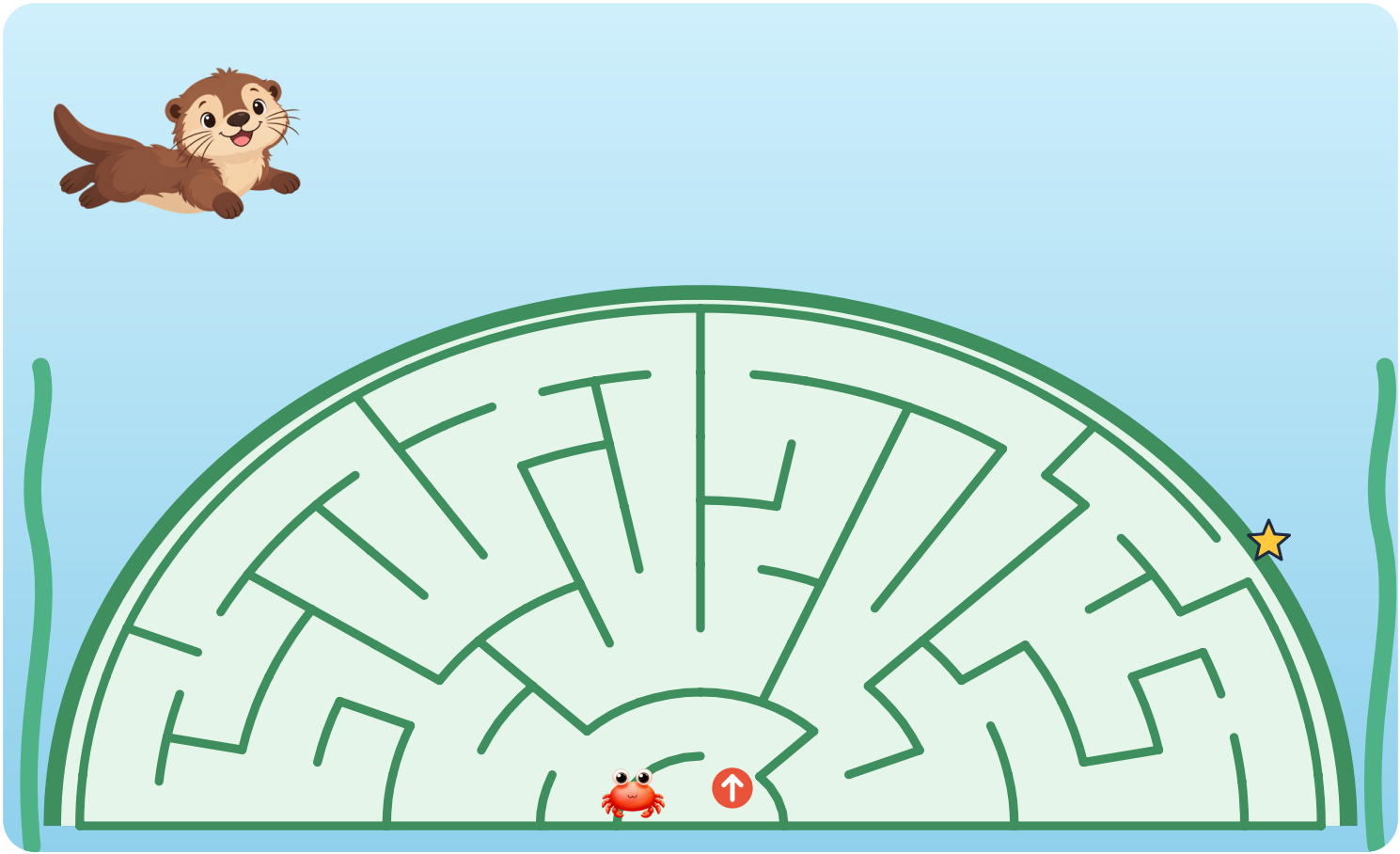


57

The kelp forest is thick and twisty tonight. Sea otters wrap themselves in kelp so they don't float away while they sleep. Help Denny find the way out through the tall kelp.

Find the sea otter swimming in the kelp.

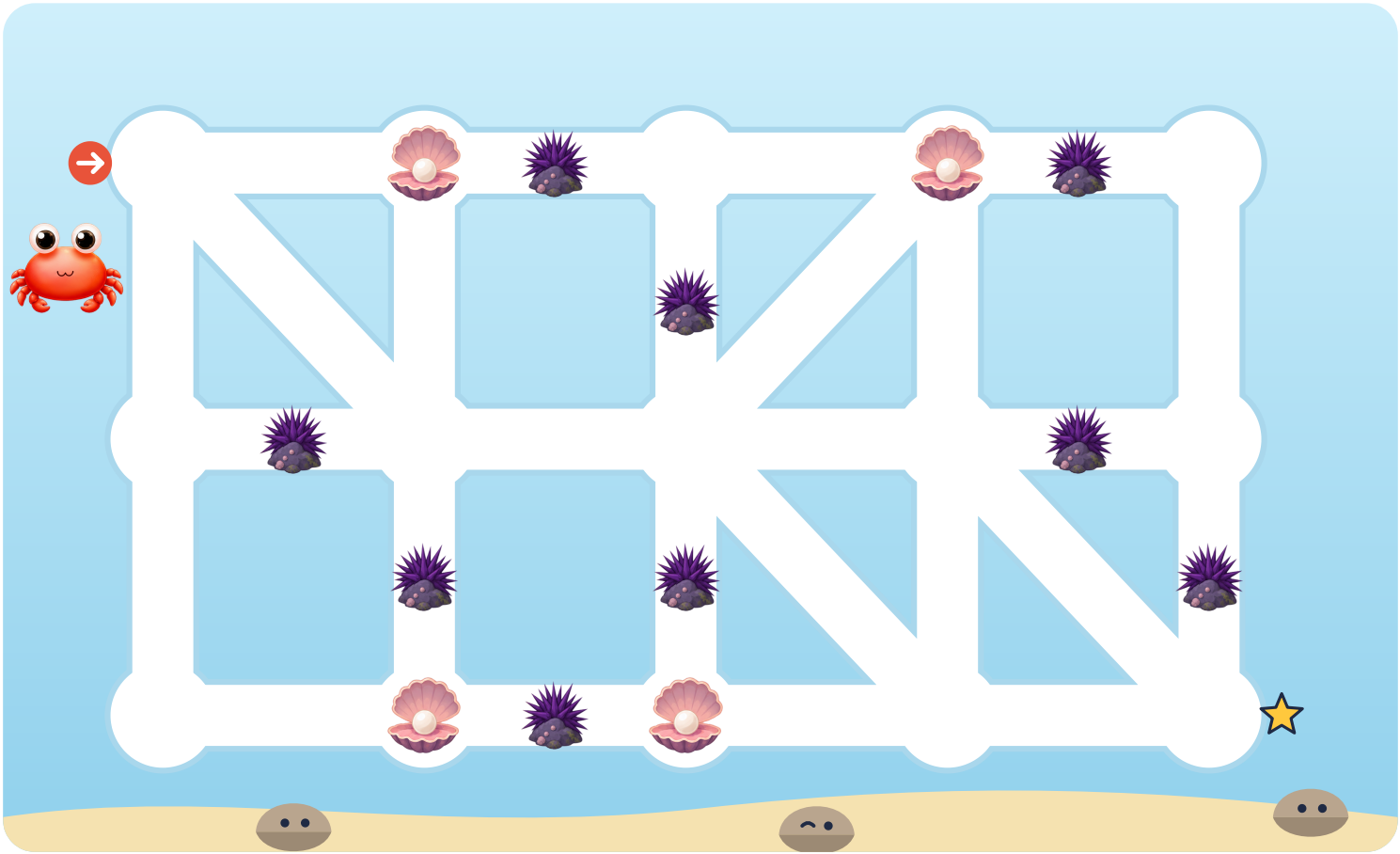
Date



58 Oysters sometimes make shiny pearls inside their shells. Collect all 4 pearls on the way, but stay away from the spiky sea urchins! Draw a line to the end without touching a single urchin.

One oyster is winking at you. Can you find it?

Date

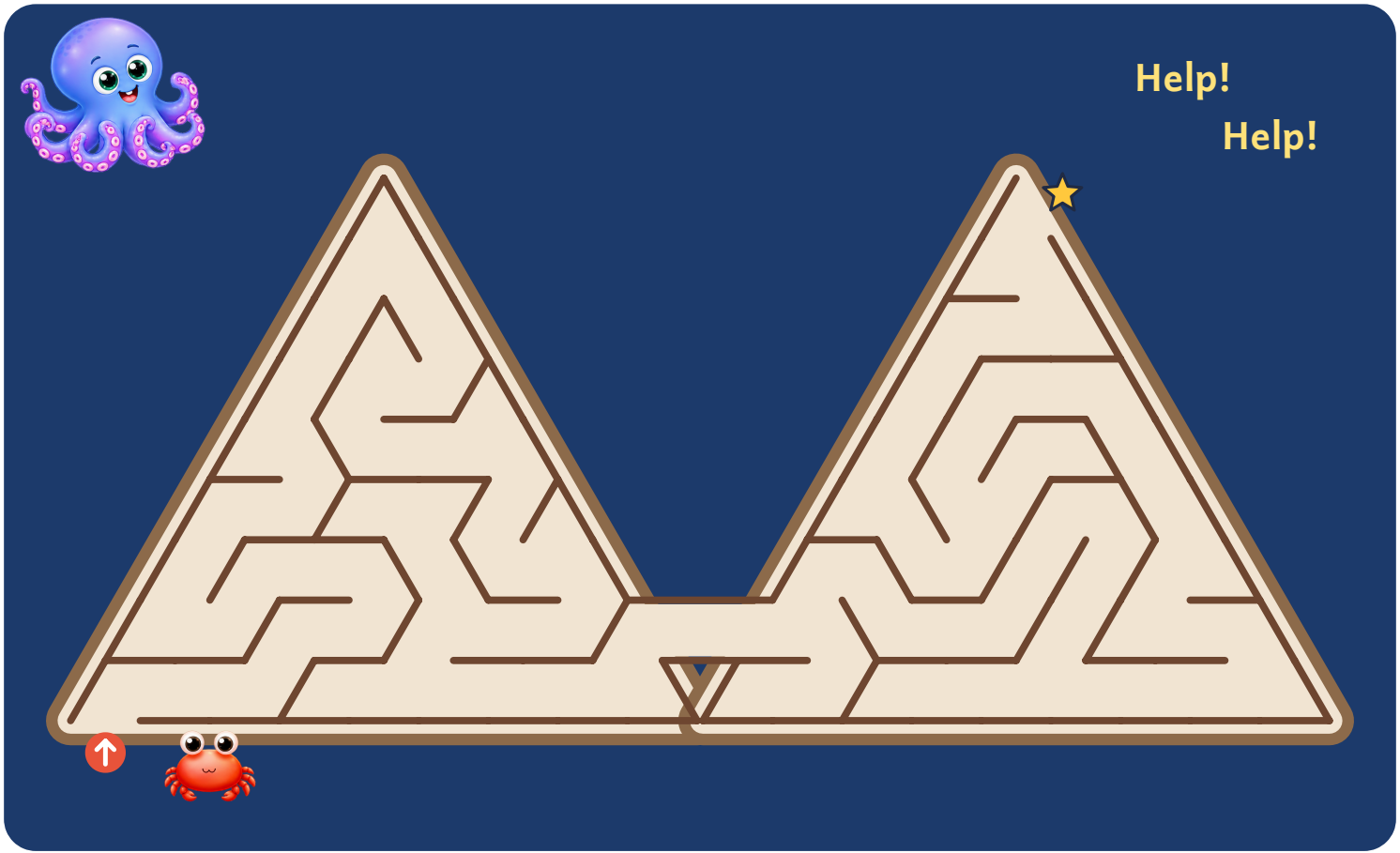


59

Denny visits Ollie in his cozy cave. Suddenly they hear a faraway cry: "Help! Help!" It sounds like Shelly! Help Denny and Ollie climb through both rocky caves and out at the top.

Octopuses have 3 hearts! Draw 3 hearts next to Ollie.

Date

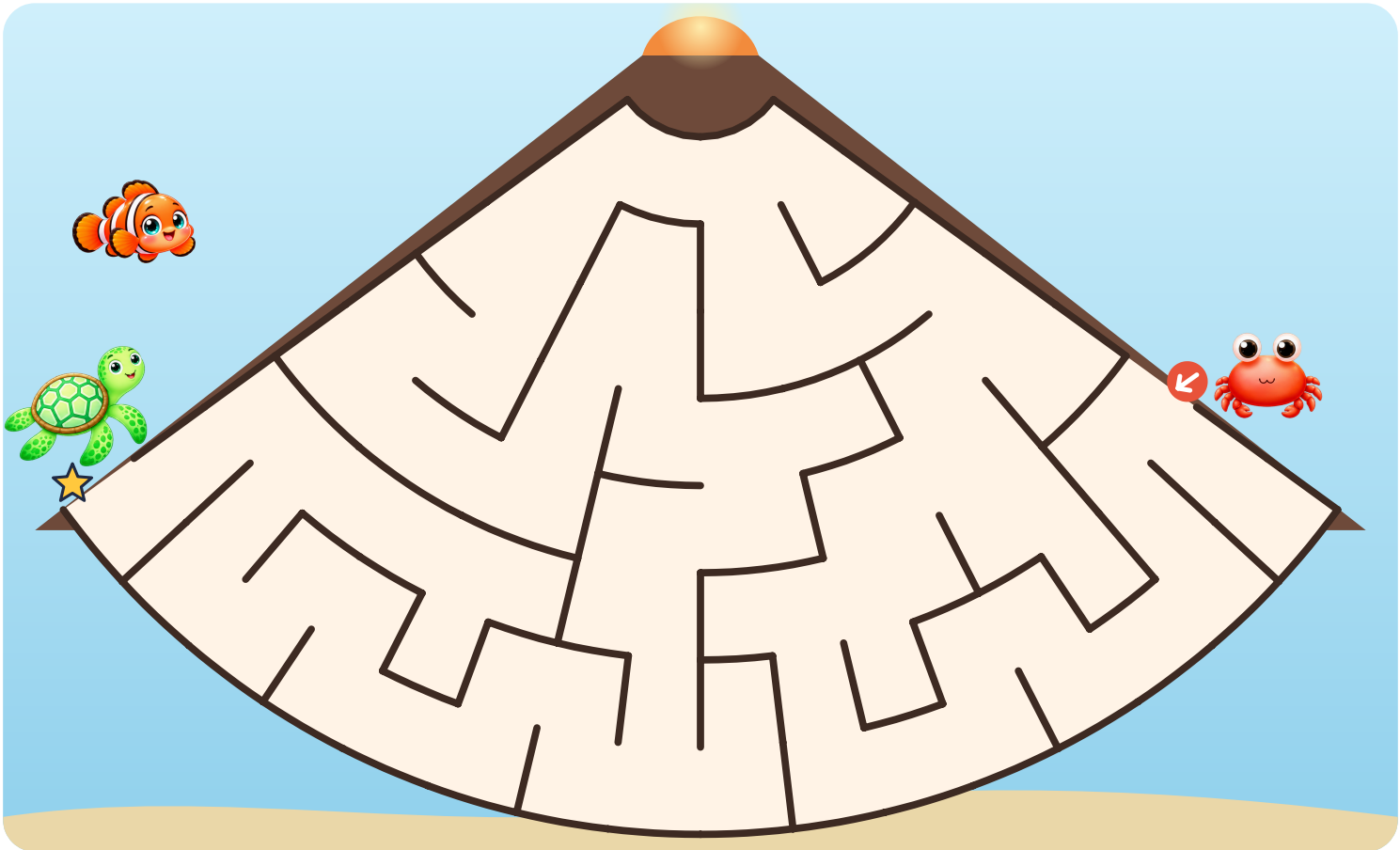


60

The cry is coming from the other side of an underwater volcano! Many coral reefs grow around old volcanoes under the sea. Help Denny find the way through the volcano to reach Shelly.

Find a clownfish hiding near the volcano.

Date

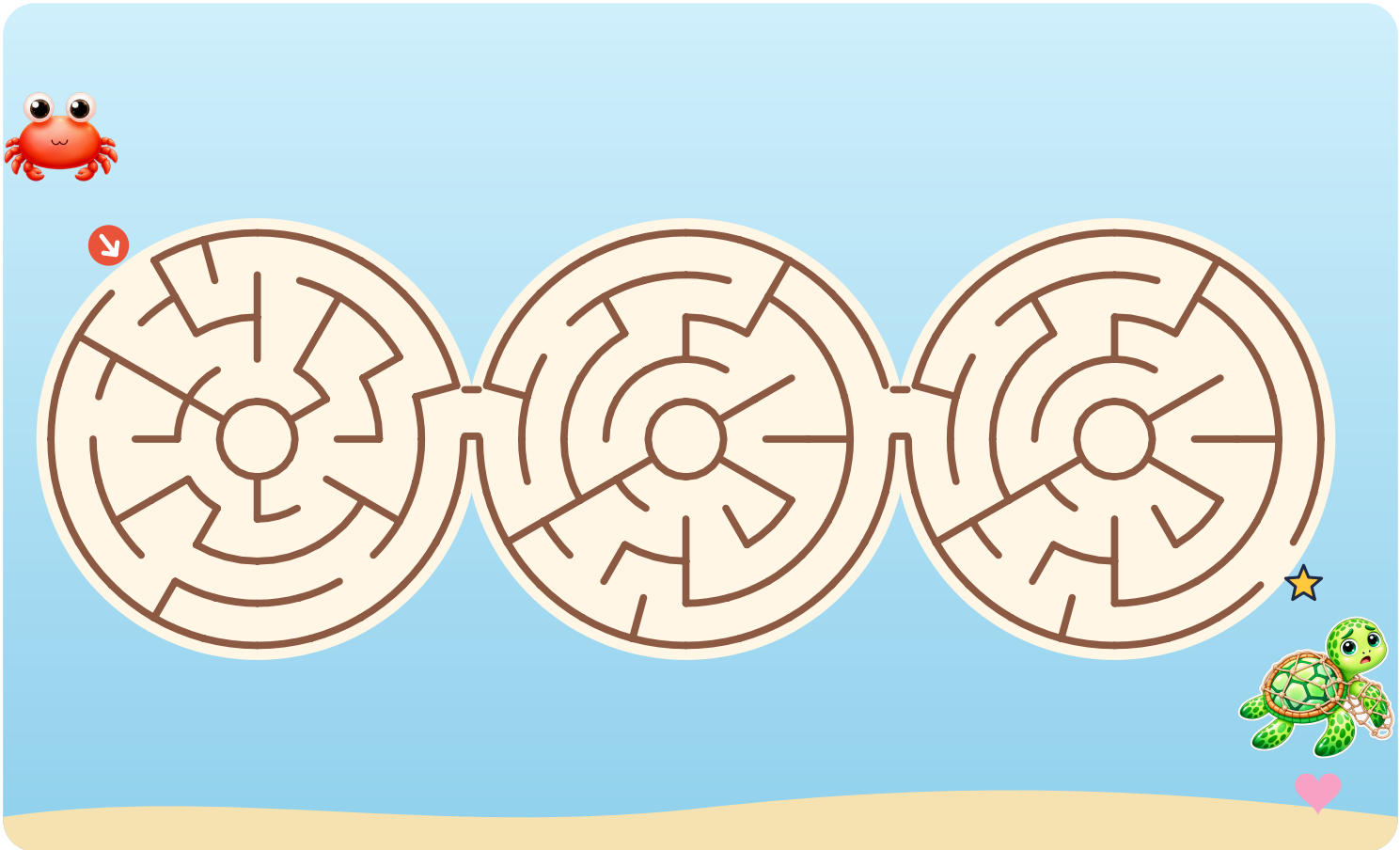


61

There she is! Shelly is caught in an old fishnet and can't swim free. Denny sees the heart shell he gave her, stuck in the net too. Swim through all three round nets to reach her.

Circle the heart shell.

Date

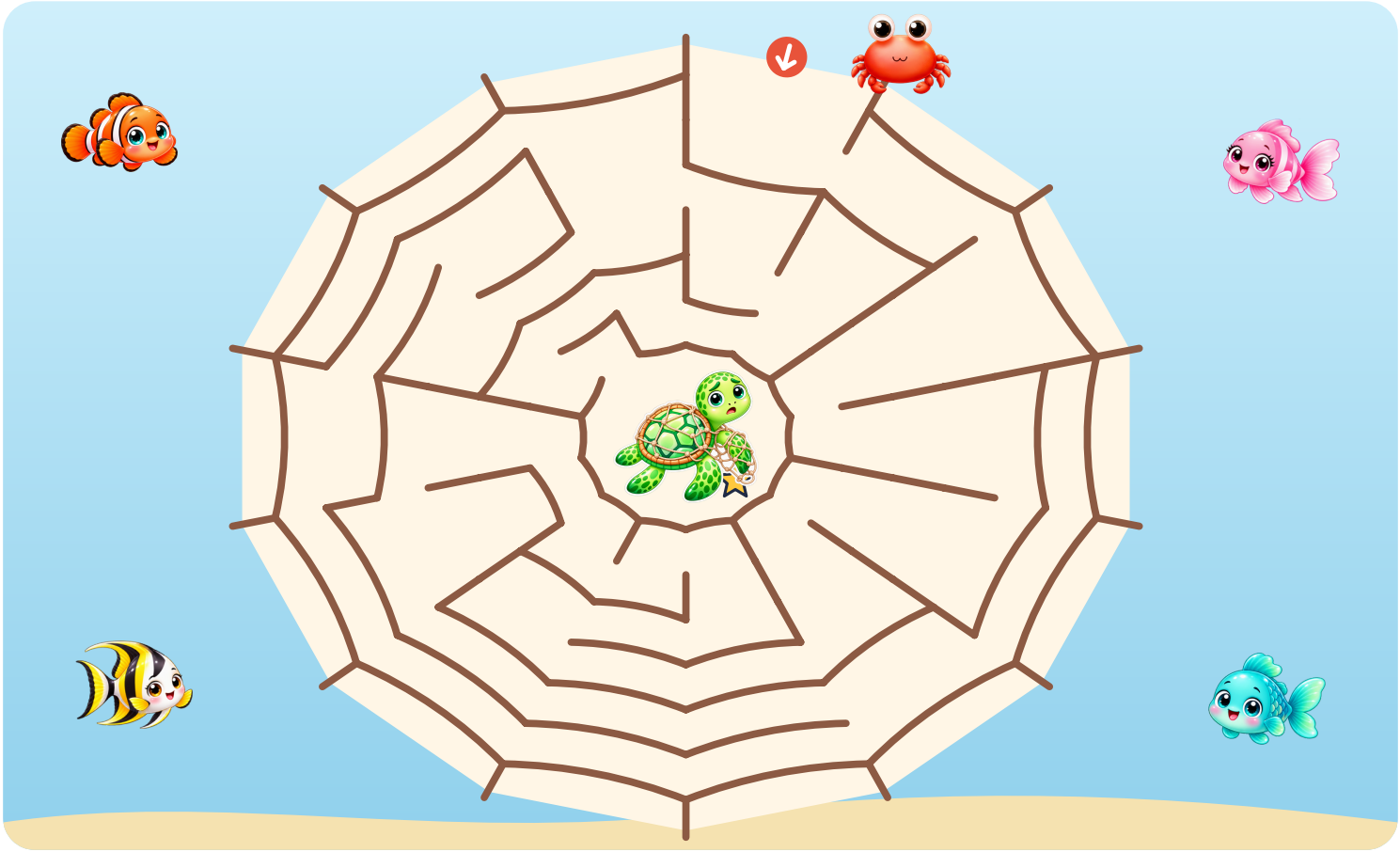


62

"Don't worry, Shelly, I'm coming!" Shelly is stuck in the middle of the net, just like a bug in a spider web. Crabs have strong claws that can snip through the rope. Find the way through the net to the center.

How many fish are swimming around the net?

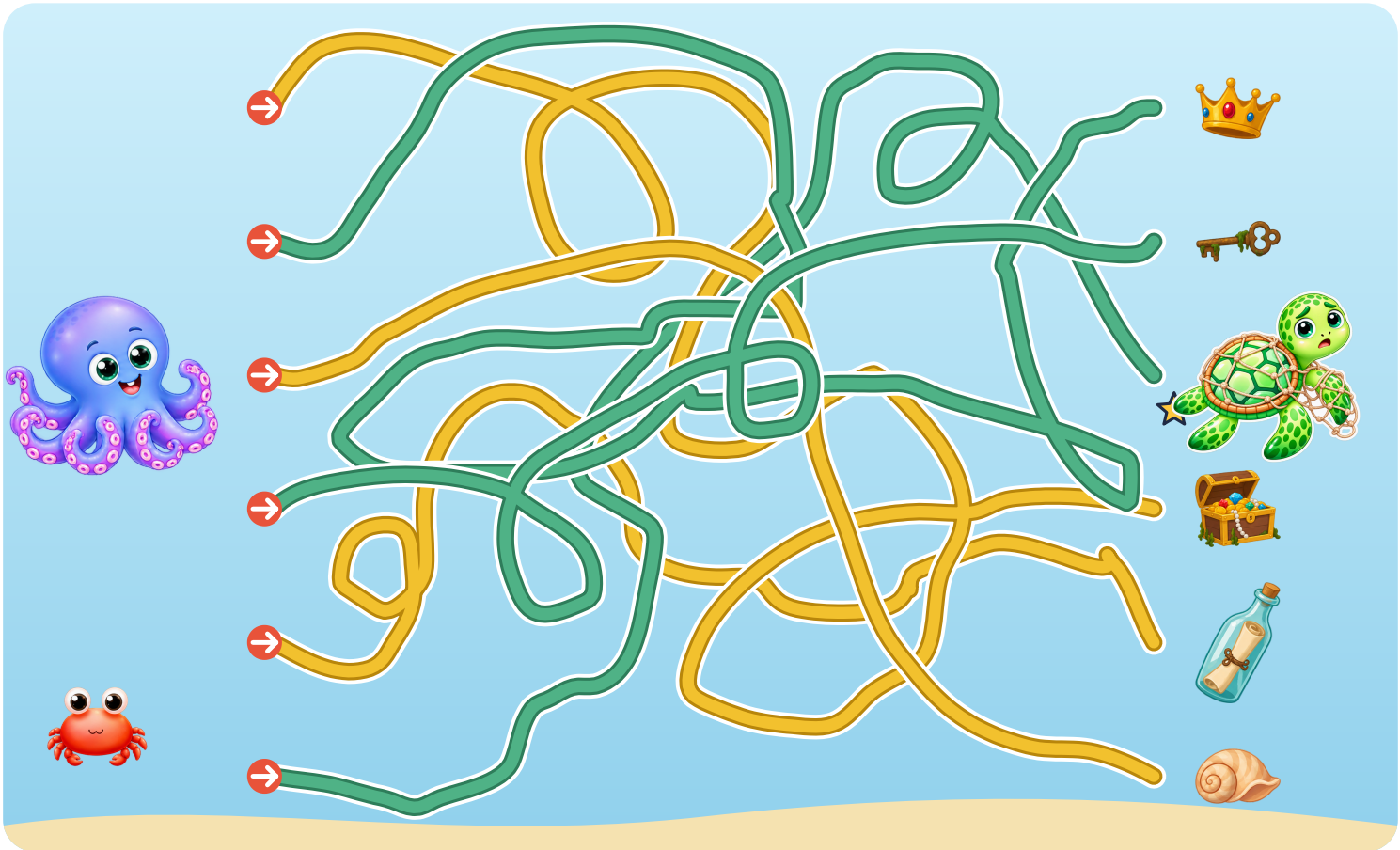
Date



63 The net is tied up with ropes! Ollie holds 6 colorful ropes, but only one of them is tied to Shelly's net. Follow each rope from start to end to see where it goes. Which rope leads to Shelly?

Which color rope leads to the golden crown?

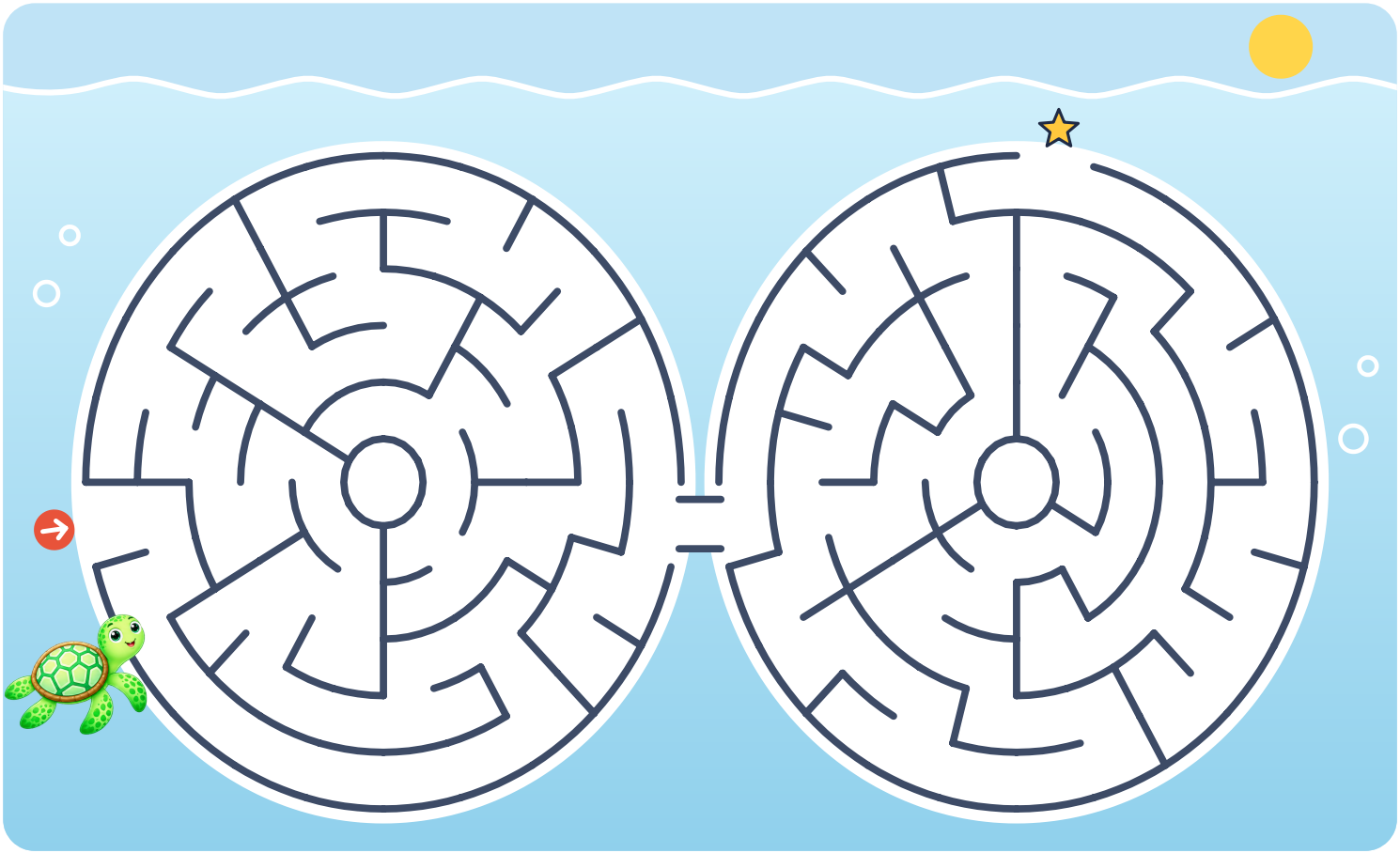
Date



Shelly is free! But she's been underwater a long time. Sea turtles need to swim up to the surface to breathe air. Help Shelly swim through both bubble mazes, up to the surface and the air.

Shelly takes a big breath. Can you take a big breath too?

Date

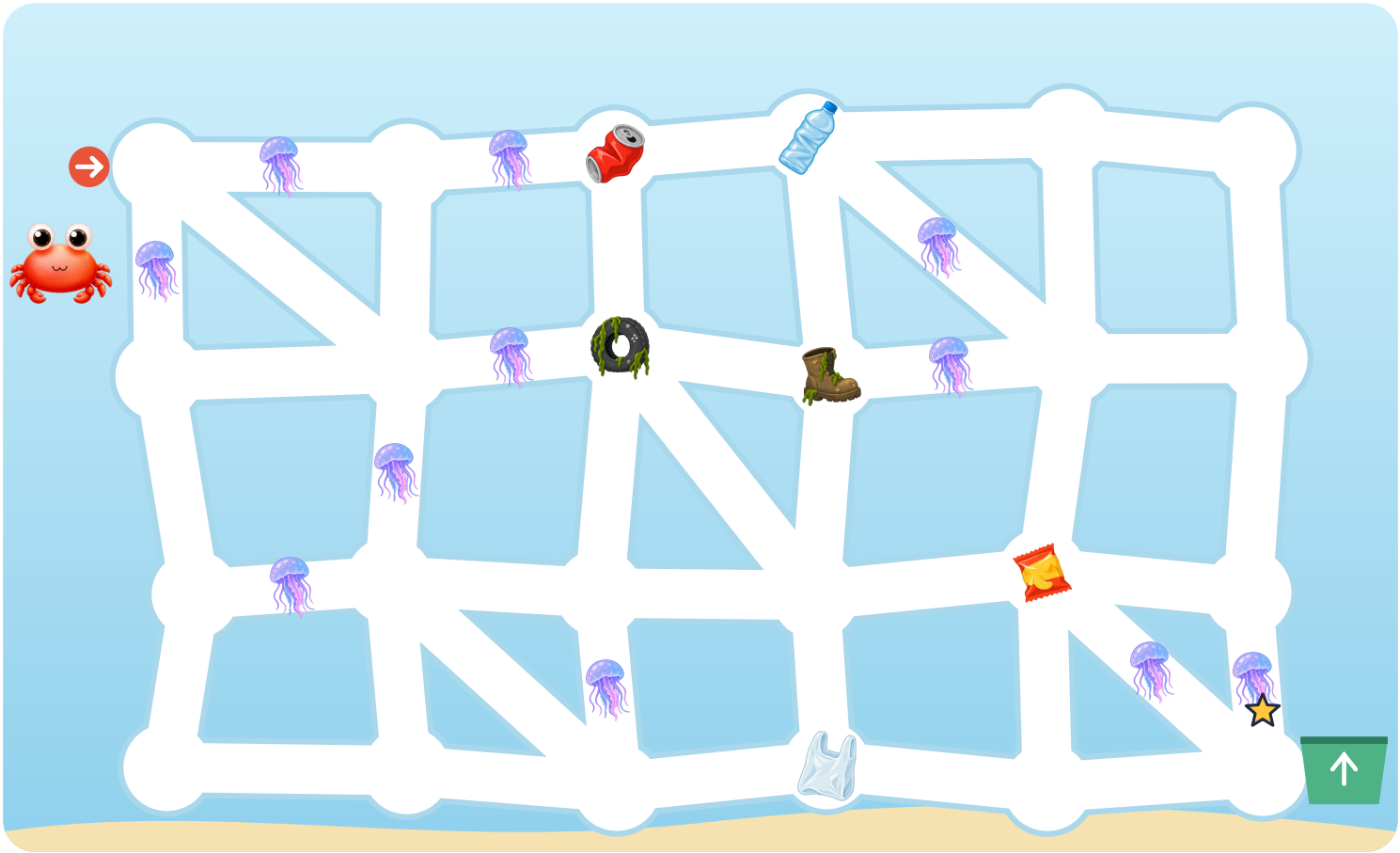


65

Old nets and trash in the ocean can hurt sea animals. Denny and his friends collect every piece of trash so no one else gets stuck. Collect all 6 pieces of trash on the way to the recycling basket, and don't swim past the stinging jellyfish!

What could you do to help keep beaches clean?

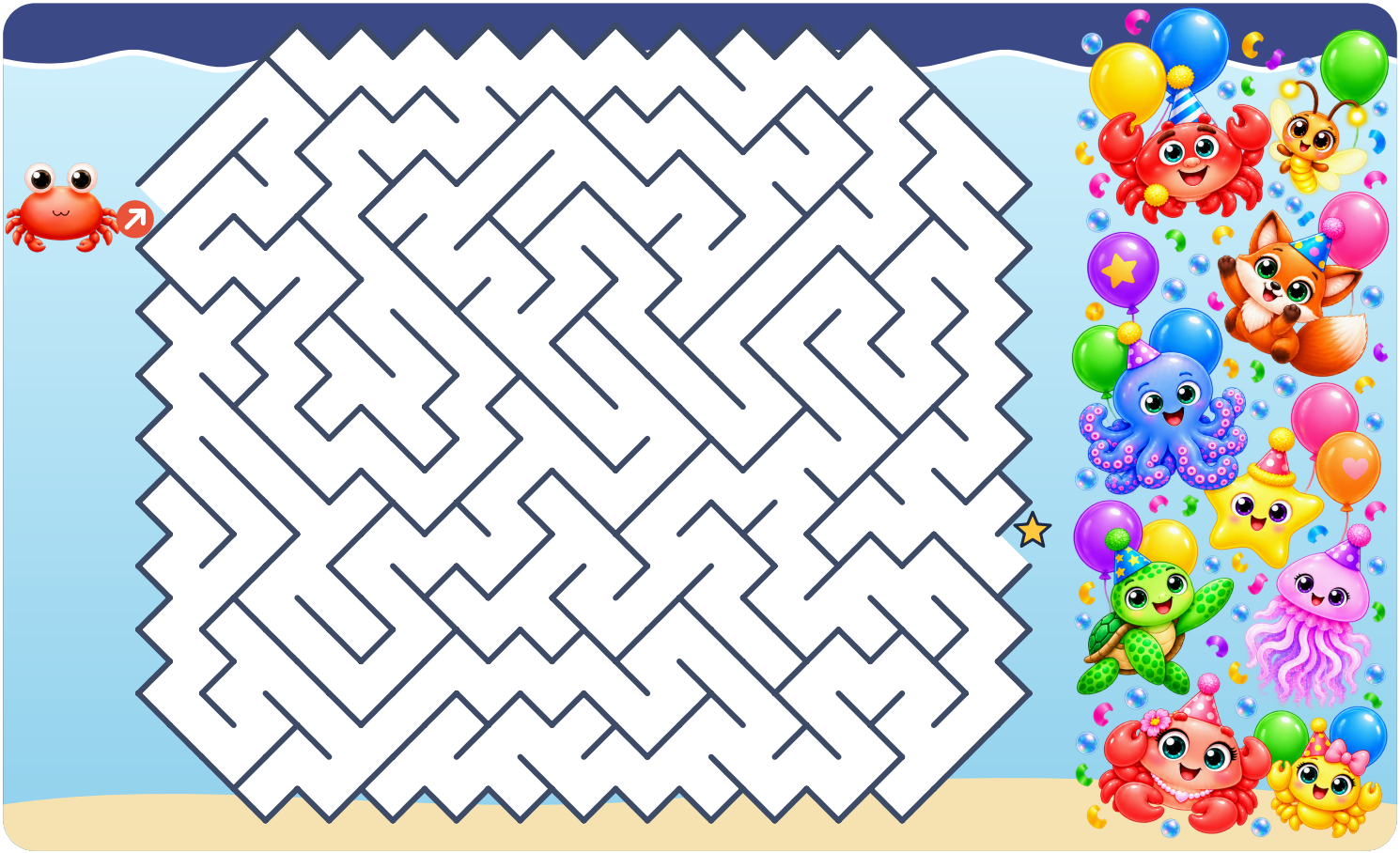
Date



Mommy Coral, Daddy Reef and Sandy have planned a surprise party for Denny, the bravest crab in the sea! Everyone is invited: Ollie, Shelly, Pearl and even Finn and Glow came to visit. Help Denny find the way home to the party.

Can you find Twinkle at the party? Draw more stars around her.

Date



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This certificate is proudly given to

_____

for helping Denny bring Twinkle home and rescue Shelly! You traced lines, shapes and numbers and solved every maze.

_____
Date

Denny, Twinkle and friends
Signed

Thank you for coming on my adventure! Tonight, look up and find a little star twinkling just for you. See you next time!